

PEOPLE AND PLACES: AN INTERMEDIATE INTEGRATED-SKILLS MODULE FOR ENGLISH LEARNERS



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Book: People and Places - An Intermediate
Integrated-Skills Module for English Learners
(Ferguson)

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

Licensing

To the Instructor

1: Introductions and the Contributions of Immigrants

- 1.1: Writing A Formal Email
- 1.2: Traditional Paragraph Structure and Email Etiquette
- 1.3: Assignment: Writing a Formal Email
- 1.4: Videos: The Contributions of Immigrants
- 1.5: Grammar: What is a Verb?
- 1.6: Grammar: Simple Sentences
- 1.7: Grammar: Imperative Mood

2: An Invitation to Visit

- 2.1: Reading a Tourism Website: Welcome to East County
- 2.2: Writing: Promotional Language
- 2.3: Randall's Listening Lab: The Four Seasons
- 2.4: Reading an ESL Reader: BC Festivals
- 2.5: Reading Strategies: BC Festivals
- 2.6: Grammar: Present Tense Verbs
- 2.7: Grammar: Compound Sentences
- 2.8: Grammar: Descriptive Adjectives
- 2.9: Assignment: Write a Persuasive Email

3: Push and Pull Factors

- 3.1: Reading a Textbook: The Great Migration
- 3.2: Reading: Culture Shock
- 3.3: Grammar: Adverbs
- 3.4: Grammar: Identifying the Past Tense
- 3.5: Grammar: Comparative and Superlative Adjectives and Adverbs

4: Guided Video Tour Project

- 4.1: Randall's ESL Listening Lab: Sightseeing
- 4.2: Assignment: Guided Video Tour
- 4.3: Vocabulary Review
- 4.4: Grammar Review
- 4.5: Grammar Review 2

[Index](#)

[Index](#)

[Glossary](#)

[Detailed Licensing](#)

Licensing

A detailed breakdown of this resource's licensing can be found in [Back Matter/Detailed Licensing](#).

To the Instructor

Dear instructor,

Thank you for choosing "People and Places" for your ESL class!

This module is designed for an intermediate level ESL class with an academic focus. It may be used alone or in conjunction with the next module in the series, "[Getting to Know You](#)." Both modules use a genre-based approach to reading, writing, speaking and listening. A variety of authentic texts on a single broad theme allow students to encounter a wide range of genres and build rhetorical flexibility. The materials present the opportunity to practice reading strategies, analyze rhetorical features, and produce original texts using the authentic texts as models. In "People and Places," students read and analyze excerpts from college level textbooks, an ESL reader, student emails, traditional paragraphs and promotional websites. They watch educational videos and guided video tours. They have the opportunity to produce a traditional paragraph, an email, a tourist blurb, and a guided video tour.

Grammar and vocabulary instruction are thematically integrated. Vocabulary activities and quizzes are included. Grammar is presented using inductive and deductive reasoning in slide presentations that offer curated videos with grammar instruction for extended study and thematically related practice activities.

I recommend using this module during the first few weeks of a semester, since it covers fundamental sentence grammar and basic email communication etiquette. The module comprises four chapters, or approximately four weeks' materials for a six-unit ESL community college class.

Materials in Google doc and Google slide format are available at [People and Places](#). Instructors can also find password protected quizzes and answer keys at that site. Please don't hesitate to contact me with any comments or questions about this module. I hope you and your students enjoy!

Sara Ferguson

Grossmont College

CHAPTER OVERVIEW

1: Introductions and the Contributions of Immigrants

Learning Objectives

After completing Chapter 1, students will be able to

1. Compose an effective formal/academic email.
2. Identify the parts of a traditional paragraph.
3. Analyze the main ideas, details and rhetorical features of videos and photos about the contributions of immigrants to American cities.
4. Use vocabulary to discuss cultural contributions of immigrants.
5. Identify verbs.
6. Identify the parts of a simple sentence and compose simple sentences.
7. Identify the imperative mood.

[1.1: Writing A Formal Email](#)

[1.2: Traditional Paragraph Structure and Email Etiquette](#)

[1.3: Assignment: Writing a Formal Email](#)

[1.4: Videos: The Contributions of Immigrants](#)

[1.5: Grammar: What is a Verb?](#)

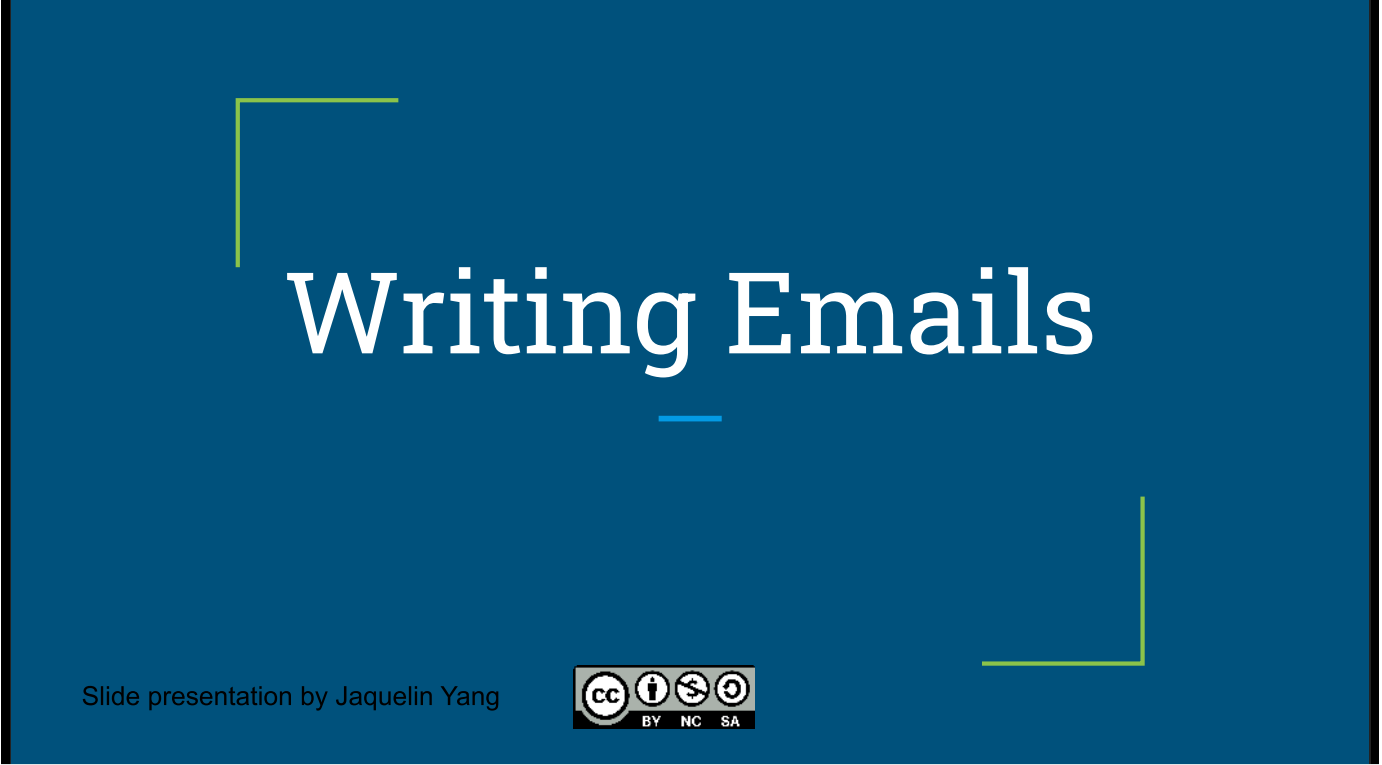
[1.6: Grammar: Simple Sentences](#)

[1.7: Grammar: Imperative Mood](#)

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1.1: Writing A Formal Email

This lesson includes [slides for classroom presentation](#).



Slide presentation by Jaquelin Yang

CC BY NC SA

Google Slides

What do we use emails for?

Some examples of what emails are used for include:

- School
- Work
- Friends and Family
- Housing
- Problems with Online Shopping

What should a good email have?

A good email should have the following:

- A clear and specific subject line
- A greeting, closing, and signature
- Proper capitalization and punctuation
- Correct spelling and grammar

A Clear and Specific Subject Line

- BAD EX: Hellooooo ^____^
- BAD EX: EMERGENCY URGENT TEACHER PLS RESPOND!!!
- GOOD EX: Absence - ESL 103
- GOOD EX: Question about test - ESL 103

Greeting

Which of the following is an appropriate greeting for... a good friend?

- Dear Mark!
- Hi Mark!
- Mr. Mark Thompson!
- Hi there!

The correct response is... Hi Mark!

Which of the following is an appropriate greeting for... a college professor I know?

- Dear Sir,
- Mr. John,

- Hello Professor Smith,
- Dear John,

The correct response is... Hello Professor Smith,

Which of the following is an appropriate greeting for... a female professor?

- Dear teacher,
- Dear Ms. Simons,
- Hello Miss!
- Dear Professor Simons,

The correct response is... Dear Professor Simons,

Which of the following is an appropriate greeting for... a new business contact if I do not know his or her name?

- Dear Sir,
- Dear Mister,
- Hello!
- Dear Sir or Madam,

The correct response is... Dear Sir or Madam,

The general rules for greetings are as follows...

- If you know the person you are writing to...
 - Dear Mr. / Ms. / Professor _____,
 - Hello _____,
 - Hi _____,
- If you do not know who will read your email...
 - Dear Sir or Madam,
 - To Whom It May Concern:

Closing and Signature

The following are appropriate closings...

- Sincerely,
- Thank you,
- Regards,
- Best,
- Thank you for your time,
- Thank you for your help,

Each of these should be followed by your full name

- GOOD EX: Sincerely, Jaquelin Yang

Proper Capitalization and Punctuation

- Do not use all capital letters or too many exclamation marks
 - BAD EX: TEACHER I WILL BE LATE TODAY!!!!!!!!!!

Correct Spelling and Grammar

- Do not use abbreviations
 - BAD EX: LOL TTYL THX
- Writing emails can be easier than talking in person... You have time to read over your emails again before you send them

Some other things to be careful of

- Use a professional email address
 - GOOD EX: jyang001@sdccd.edu
 - BAD EX: happiiteacherr@gmail.com
- Do not use emojis in emails
 - BAD EX: I will be late today :(sorry :(

Some other things in the email

- Attach: Use "attach" to send things like essays, pictures, videos, etc.
 - If you attach something, make sure you say it in the email
 - GOOD EX: I have attached my essay to this email
- CC: Use "CC" to send an email to more than one person. CC is usually for people who need this information but do not need to respond
 - GOOD EX: I might send an email TO my professor but I CC the tutor in the class
- BCC: This is for when you need to send the email to a lot of people, but for privacy reasons, you do not want to show their names
 - This is mostly used for business emails

Useful links to review at home

- [Useful email phrases](#)
- [Grammar and phrases for emails](#)
- [More instructions for business emails](#)

Attribution

Jaquelin Yang, ESL Instructor Grossmont College

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1.2: Traditional Paragraph Structure and Email Etiquette

Read the composition about email etiquette. Examine the structure of the composition to learn about traditional paragraph structure

Email Etiquette

Email is used in almost all aspects of life – we use email at school, at work, and in our personal lives. The way we write emails is essential to being an effective communicator. The way we write an email could be the difference between getting a job interview and not getting the interview. It could be the difference between having our professor help us with our homework or ignoring us and not helping. Have you ever opened an email and thought that the writer was rude or unprofessional? Maybe you decided not to answer this person, or your reply was not very helpful or kind. That person may have thought that they had sent a polite email asking a simple question, but you did not interpret it that way. Unfortunately, this is common, and it can lead to many misunderstandings. Therefore, we must be careful to write emails that are professional, polite, and clear.

How then can we write professional and clear emails? There are a few tips you can follow. First, the subject line of the email should state the reason for the email. For example, “Question About Homework” is clear and concise. This is better than saying “Help!” which is not clear. This sounds like an emergency, even though it is not. Second, do not use all capital letters. Capital letters, like “WHEN IS THE PAPER DUE?” make the reader think you are shouting, or yelling at them. This is very impolite and may make the reader upset. Instead, use correct punctuation. Check to make sure you have capitalized the first letter of a sentence and all proper nouns. This shows the reader that you took the time to proofread your email. Third, be very clear about why you are writing. Do not write too much; people receive hundreds of emails a day, so they do not have time to read an essay! Be clear and concise. Finally, always say “thank you” at the end. Sometimes, we are angry and do not want to say “thank you,” but showing this politeness will help you later. If you are polite and thankful, the reader is more likely to respond and to help you. Emails are an important part of communication; make sure you use them correctly so that they benefit you.

Traditional Paragraph Structure

The composition “Email Etiquette” follows the traditional paragraph structure for both paragraphs. What are the parts of a traditional paragraph? Complete these activities to identify the parts of a traditional paragraph.

- With your instructor, underline and label the parts of the traditional paragraph in the first paragraph
 - title
 - topic sentence
 - concluding sentence
- What is the topic of the composition? How do you know?
- What is the purpose of the first paragraph? (circle one answer)
 - to show how to write an effective email
 - to define email etiquette
 - to explain why email etiquette is important
 - to give more information about emails
- Read the second paragraph. What is the purpose of the second paragraph? You may choose from the list in the third question
- What signal words does the author use to introduce four tips? How many sentences does the author write for each tip?
- Write notes about the four tips. Your notes should be keywords only, not sentences

Attribution

"Email Etiquette" Tina-Marie Parker, Grossmont College, adapted by Sara Ferguson

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1.3: Assignment: Writing a Formal Email

Self-Introduction and Email Assignment

For this assignment, you will send an email to your professor. Use the tips in [1.1 Writing a Formal Email](#) and [1.2 Paragraph Structure and Email Etiquette](#). The purpose of this email is to introduce yourself by email.

Email Guidelines

The email should follow the email guidelines in [1.1 Writing a Formal Email](#) and [1.2 Paragraph Structure and Email Etiquette](#).

- Send your email to your professor at _____.
- The subject line should state what the email will be about. It should be short and specific.
- Address the reader by his or her title, unless the reader asks you not to.
- Organization:
 - Identify yourself. Write your full name and state which class you are in.
 - Give a pleasantry, or short greeting. This makes the tone friendly and polite.
 - State the reason for writing. Give some background information if necessary.
 - Thank the reader and include a short sign-off.

Self-Introduction Guidelines

- The self-introduction should be attached.
- Write 1 or 2 paragraphs
- Complete the self- introduction on a Word doc or compatible.
- Give specific information that is relevant to your audience (your professor)
 - Languages you speak, purpose for attending college, English language goals, hobbies or interests, and any other information that you think your professor should know

Other Notes about Emails

- If you include an attachment, tell the reader that a file is attached
- If you have many questions, make a list. This will help the reader see all of the questions so that he or she will respond to them all.
- Use white space in between sections of your email. This makes it easier to read.
- Keep emails short and specific.

How to Attach a Document

- Write your self-introduction on Word or compatible.
- Save the document with your self-introduction.
- When you open a new email, click the "Attachment" button. Sometimes, it looks like a paperclip.
- Find the saved document. Click "Open." This will attach it to your email.

Grading Rubric: How Will Your Assignment Be Graded?

Criteria	Description	Points
Subject line	The subject line is short. It tells the reader the main idea of the email.	1
Greeting and pleasantry	The email contains an appropriate address to the reader and one or two sentences of well-wishes.	2
Identity and purpose	The email states the identity of the writer, including class and full name, and the purpose of the email, including attachment of introduction.	4
Closing	The email has an appropriate closing and signature line.	1
Self-introduction	The self-introduction uses paragraph format and has one or two paragraphs. It introduces the writer with details that are meaningful for the audience (your professor) such as country of origin, first language, family, goals, past experiences with school, interest and hobbies . It is typed in doc or docx format and attached to the email. The introduction has been edited for grammar and mechanics (spelling).	12
Total points		20

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1.4: Videos: The Contributions of Immigrants

Watching an Educational Video: San Francisco's Mission District

Before you watch, discuss or write about these questions...

- This video is about immigrants in the Mission District, an area in San Francisco. What do you know already about San Francisco?
- When immigrants move to a city, what benefits do they bring to that city? Think about the immigrants in your own city when you answer this question

Now, watch the video below.



Waves of immigration make San Francisco's mission district one of the city's liveliest and most colorful areas.

<https://youtu.be/l2HN7P9Y7aE>

Main Idea and Genre Comprehension

Watch the video one time and answer the questions below.

- Choose the answer which best fills in the blank. This video is _____ (genre).
 - A commercial selling art in the Mission District
 - A romance-comedy about a couple in San Francisco
 - An educational video about the contributions of immigrants to the Mission District
 - An educational video explaining the history of San Francisco
- Who is the audience for this video? Choose all that apply and then discuss with your instructor.
 - Tourists deciding where to vacation
 - Any adult interested in CA history
 - Immigrants deciding where to move
 - Children under 12
 - Politicians trying to solve problems in the city
 - Real estate agents learning about housing prices
- What is the purpose of this video? Choose all that apply.
 - To convince people that immigrants help improve a neighborhood
 - To explain what is special about the Mission District
 - To convince people that they should move to the Mission District
 - To convince people that they should vacation in the Mission District
- What elements of the video helped you decide the answers to the questions above? Choose all that apply and then discuss with your instructor.
 - The topics

- The images in the video
- The narration
- The length
- Where are the latest immigrants in the Mission District from?
- What cultural contributions do Hispanic immigrants make to the Mission District? Choose only those that were mentioned or shown in the video.
 - Art
 - Business
 - Music
 - Language
 - Religion
 - Law
 - Holidays
 - Marriage Customs
 - Food
- The video shows many pictures of Mission Dolores. What is Mission Dolores?
 - A restaurant
 - A church
 - An art exhibit
 - A music concert

Listening for Details and Vocabulary

Listen a second time and fill in the blanks.

- The Mission Dolores was built in the year _____.
- Hispanic immigrants are the latest group to come to the Mission District but, before them, _____, _____, and _____ people immigrated to the area.

Which of the following words did you hear in the video?

- Cultural (adj)
- Immigrants (n)
- Grievs (n)
- Joys (n)
- Integration (n)
- Hispanic (adj)
- Public (adj)

Use the words above to fill in the blanks.

The Mission District in San Francisco, California has many _____ from Mexico, Latin America, and Central America. People from these countries speak Spanish, so they are sometimes called _____. The people who live in the Mission District keep their _____ identity by sharing their food, religion, art, and music. The music allows them to experience their _____ and _____--that is, the things that make them sad and happy. The artists create _____ art that is outside, where everyone can see it and enjoy it. The video shows that the Mission District is a good example of _____, where the old culture and new culture mix peacefully.

Watching a News Report: El Cajon, California

Pre-Watch

Skim the photos in the article, [Baghdad on the Border](#), and answer the question below...

- What aspects of their cultural identity have Chaldean Iraqis brought to their new home? Make a list. You may use vocabulary from the previous section, or add your own.

While You Watch

Watch the video, "[Thousands of Iraqi Christians Make El Cajon California Home](#)", and answer the questions below...

- Where is this news report published? What is the name of the website?
- What is the purpose of this news report? Choose one
 - To convince people that Chaldean immigrants help improve El Cajon
 - To explain what is special about Chaldean immigrants
 - To convince people that they should move to El Cajon
 - To convince people that they should vacation in El Cajon
- Does this video show the integration of Chaldean Iraqis in El Cajon, CA? What parts of the video help you decide the answer to this question?

Discuss or Write

These photos and videos show the many aspects of their first culture that immigrants can bring to a new home, such as art, music, food, and religion. They continue to practice these aspects of their culture. Consider your own experience. What aspects of your culture have you brought to the United States? Will you continue to practice those aspects of your culture?

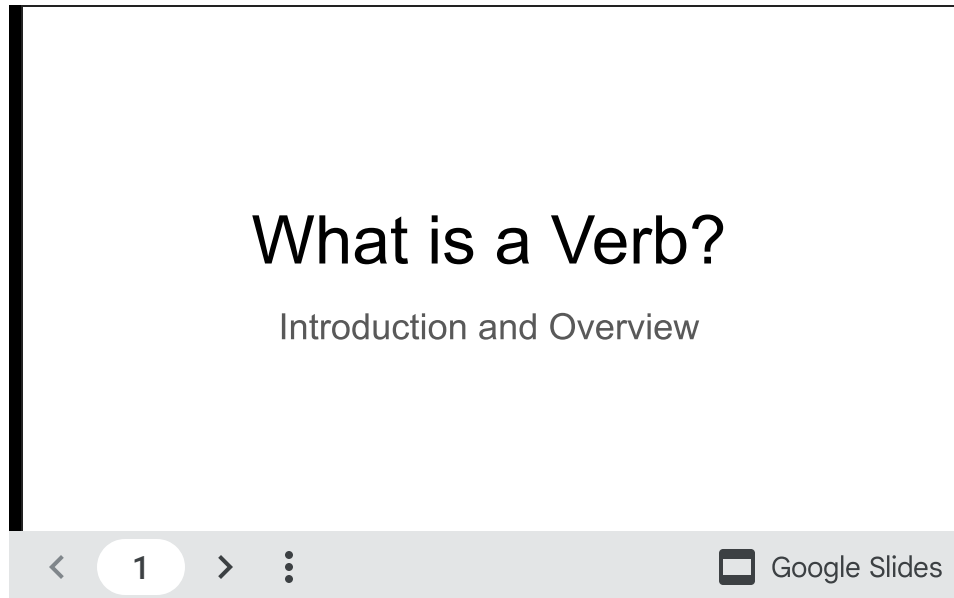
Vocabulary Definitions

- Culture (n): The way of life of a group of people. Culture includes art, music, religion, language, food, tradition, and many other aspects. The adjective form is "cultural"
- Immigrant (n): A person who comes to live permanently in a foreign country
- Grief (n): A feeling of sadness or something that causes sadness
- Joy (n): A feeling of happiness or something that causes happiness
- Integration (n): When two cultures mix (blend, combine) in a society and both cultures have equal value
- Hispanic (adj): Coming from a Spanish-speaking country
- Public (adj): Relating to or open to all people in an area

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1.5: Grammar: What is a Verb?

This lesson is available as [slides for classroom presentation](#).



Why Learn About Verbs?

The verb is the core (center, foundation) for the English sentence. We cannot have a sentence without a verb. When trying to decide if a sentence is complete and correct, we usually look for the verb first.

Verbs are so important, we can even have a sentence that is only one word--the verb!

- Study!
- Eat!
- Help!

Some people say the verb is the part of the sentence that shows action. Do all of these words show action?

- Tornado
- Wave
- Windy

In fact, these words (tornado and wave) are nouns and (windy) an adjective, even though they show activity

Which of these words show action? Which are verbs?

- Show/Laugh
- Think/Understand

All of these words are verbs. Some are about activities (show and laugh) and some are not (think and understand)

What Makes a Word a Verb?

A verb shows tense (time)

- Past--flew
- Present--flies
- Future--will fly

A verb shows aspect

- Simple--flew, flies

- Continuous--is flying, was flying
- Perfect--has flown, had flown

One way to decide if a word is a verb is to look at the changes you can make to the word. Can you add -ed for past tense? Does the word change to show past tense?

Which of these words can show past tense by changing form or adding -ed?

- Tornado
- Windy
- Think
- Understand
- Show
- Laugh
- Wave
- Fly

Answers to the above question:

- Tornado (noun--no change)
- Windy (adjective--no change)
- Think (verb--thought)
- Understand (verb--understood)
- Show (verb--showed)
- Laugh (verb--laughed)
- Wave (noun--no change)
- Fly (verb--flew)

Auxiliaries

Verbs use auxiliaries to make questions and negatives and to show different voices and aspects

The auxiliaries are "be," "do," and "have," plus modals

These auxiliaries can also change tense

- Be, am, is, are, was, were
- Do, does, did
- Have, has, had

We use "do" to make questions and negatives in the simple aspect

- Simple present
 - Do you want a souvenir?
 - I do not want a souvenir
- Simple past
 - Did you visit the art museum?
 - I did not visit the art museum

We use "be" to make the continuous aspect

- Present continuous
 - She is picnicking at the park
 - Are they flying a kite?
 - No, they aren't flying a kite
- Past continuous
 - We were sunbathing at the beach

Remember, verbs in the continuous aspect always use "be." If you see -ing with "be," it's a gerund

We use "have" to make the perfect aspect

- Present perfect
 - Have you visited downtown San Diego?
 - That family has immigrated to El Cajon
- Past perfect
 - We had already seen the zoo

Now you try...

Now that you know what a verb is, try finding the verb in these sentences...

- The weather today is cool and breezy
- East County, San Diego offers activities like hiking, camping, and mountain-biking
- Last week, we went to the zoo and the park
- Immigrants contribute many cultural benefits to our community
- Julian, CA has a variety of restaurants

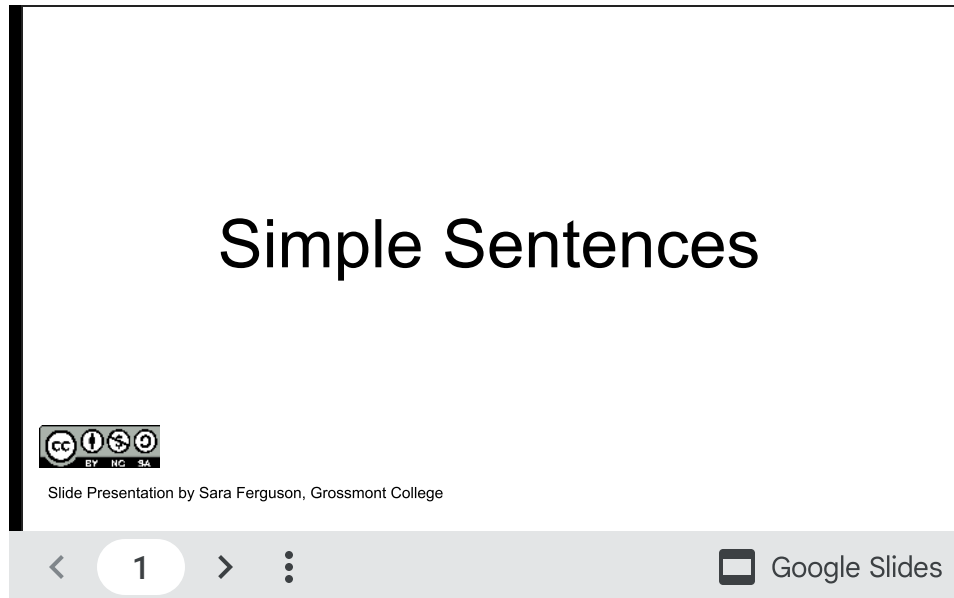
Answers to the above question:

- Is
- Offers
- Went
- Contribute
- Has

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1.6: Grammar: Simple Sentences

This lesson is available as [slides for classroom presentation](#).



Subjects and Verbs

Label the subject and verb in each sentence...

- San Diego has warm weather
- We live in San Diego County
- The weather today seems dry
- Grossmont College is in El Cajon
- Some students at this college are immigrants

Answers to the above exercise:

- San Diego (subject), has (verb)
- We (subject), live (verb)
- The weather (subject), seems (verb)
- Grossmont College (subject), is (verb)
- Some students at this college (students), are (verb)

Simple Sentence Patterns

A group of words with a subject and a verb is called a clause; a simple sentence has one clause

Simple sentences use four patterns:

- Subject + verb (noun phrase) or (prepositional phrase)
 - EX: San Diego has warm weather
 - EX: We live in San Diego County
- Subject + linking verb + adjective
 - EX: The weather today seems dry
- Subject + "be" + noun phrase
 - EX: Some students at this college are immigrants
- Subject + "be" + prepositional phrase

- EX: Grossmont College is in El Cajon

Predicates

The part of the sentence or clause with the verb is called the "predicate"

- San Diego has warm weather

The subject is "San Diego" and the predicate is "has warm weather"

- We live in El Cajon

The subject is "we" and the predicate is "live in El Cajon"

Verbs

Verbs can show action or non-action

- Action verbs--jump, read, talk, ask
- Stative (non-action) verbs--understand, like, be, seem

Verbs change form to show time (past, present, and future), aspect, voice, and mood

Linking Verbs

Linking verbs are different from other verbs because they may be followed by an adjective. Other verbs may not. They are not the same as stative (non-action) verbs because most stative verbs cannot be followed by an adjective. For example...

- BAD EX: He owned nice
- BAD EX: She believed wonderful

The subject in a linking verb sentence may sometimes be "there" or "it"

- EX: It seems cold today
- EX: There are 26 students in this class

Practice What You Learned

The following sentences are about people and places. Identify the subject, verb or linking verb, noun phrase, adjective, and prepositional phrase in each sentence. You may find some adverbs as well...

- Grossmont College is a community college
- It is on Grossmont College Drive in El Cajon
- El Cajon is in East County
- Most Grossmont students travel to the college by car
- El Cajon has many attractive features
- There are libraries, parks, and schools
- Approximately 100,000 people live here
- The climate is Mediterranean
- The weather is usually warm and dry
- It seems hot today

Answers to the above exercise:

- The subject is "Grossmont College," the verb or linking verb is "is," the noun phrase is "a community college"
- The subject is "it," the verb or linking verb is "is," the prepositional phrase is "on Grossmont College Drive" and "in El Cajon"
- The subject is "El Cajon," the verb or linking verb is "is," the prepositional phrase is "in East County"
- The subject is "most Grossmont students," the verb or linking verb is "travel," the prepositional phrase is "to the college by car"
- The subject is "El Cajon," the verb or linking verb is "has," the noun phrase is "many attractive features"
- The subject is "there," the verb or linking verb is "are," the noun phrase is "libraries, parks, and schools"
- The subject is "approximately 100,000 people," the verb or linking verb is "live," the noun phrase is "here"

- The subject is "the climate," the verb or linking verb is "is," the adjective is "Mediterranean"
- The subject is "the weather," the verb or linking verb is "is," the adjective is "warm and dry"
- The subject is "it," the verb or linking verb is "seems"

Watch This Video

Watch [this video](#) for another explanation of simple sentences...

Homework

Write five simple sentences about a place you know well. Label the parts of each sentence

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1.7: Grammar: Imperative Mood

Understanding and Using the Imperative Mood

Form: Imperative Mood

Read the summary below to learn how to form the imperative mood.

The imperative mood is the base form of the verb. The subject is the implied ‘you,’ but the subject is not written in the sentence.

Imperative mood = base form verb + (complement)

- Example: Open the door! (Open is the base form of the verb. The door is the complement.)

Negative imperative = Do not (don’t) + base form + (complement)

- Example: Don’t forget your umbrella! (Forget is the base form of the verb. Your umbrella is the complement).

Meaning: Imperative Mood

The imperative mood is used to make requests, give instructions or directions, and give orders.

Request: Sit down, please.

Instructions: Read the first part of the chapter.

Orders: Leave now!

Practice Paragraph: Email Etiquette

Identify the verbs in the imperative mood in this paragraph.

How then can we write professional and clear emails? There are a few tips you can follow. First, the subject line of the email should state the reason for the email. For example, “Question About Homework” is clear and concise. This is better than saying “Help!” which is not clear. This sounds like an emergency, even though it is not. Second, do not use all capital letters. Capital letters, like “WHEN IS THE PAPER DUE?” make the reader think you are shouting, or yelling at them. This is very impolite and may make the reader upset. Instead, use correct punctuation. Check to make sure you capitalized the first letter of a sentence and all proper nouns. This shows the reader that you took the time to proofread your email. Third, be very clear about why you are writing. Do not write too much; people receive hundreds of emails a day, so they do not have time to read an essay! Be clear and concise. Finally, always say “thank you” at the end. Sometimes, we are angry and do not want to say “thank you,” but showing this politeness will

help you later. If you are polite and thankful, the reader is more likely to respond and to help you. Emails are an important part of communication; make sure you use them correctly so that they benefit you.

For more information about the imperative mood, watch [this video](#).

For more practice with the Imperative Mood, use [this website](#).

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

2: An Invitation to Visit

Learning Objectives

After completing this chapter, students will be able to

1. Analyze rhetorical features of a promotional blurb on a tourism website.
2. Analyze and practice composing sentences in a promotional genre.
3. Listen to a presentation about the four seasons and identify the main ideas and details.
4. Read an ESL text about festivals.
5. Practice reading and writing strategies including word forms and capitalization
6. Use vocabulary related to seasons and activities to describe a place.
7. Use simple present tense to describe a place.
8. Use compound sentences to write about a place.
9. Use positive descriptive adjectives to describe a place.
10. Write an email inviting a tourist to visit a place.

[2.1: Reading a Tourism Website: Welcome to East County](#)

[2.2: Writing: Promotional Language](#)

[2.3: Randall's Listening Lab: The Four Seasons](#)

[2.4: Reading an ESL Reader: BC Festivals](#)

[2.5: Reading Strategies: BC Festivals](#)

[2.6: Grammar: Present Tense Verbs](#)

[2.7: Grammar: Compound Sentences](#)

[2.8: Grammar: Descriptive Adjectives](#)

[2.9: Assignment: Write a Persuasive Email](#)

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2.1: Reading a Tourism Website: Welcome to East County

Pre-Reading Activity

With your instructor or classmates, discuss a travel vacation you have taken in the past or a travel vacation you will take in the future. What activities do you enjoy the most when you travel for a vacation?

Vocabulary Preview

Examine [these photos](#). Do you know the words for these places and activities?

Reading

Go to [this website](#) and read the tourism blurb.

Reading Questions

After you read, answer these questions to check your understanding.

- What is the title of the web page? Where did you find the title?
- What location is the web page describing?
- Who might like to read this web page? (the audience)
 - Children in elementary school
 - Tourists who want to travel to Southern California
 - Immigrants who want to move to San Diego
 - Politicians who want to understand the problems in the area
- What is the purpose of the web page? In other words, what does the author want the reader to do?
 - Explain why East County is a good place to live
 - Give information about East County
 - Convince the reader to visit East County on vacation
 - Give the history of East County
- How did you decide the purpose of the web page? In other words, what parts of the page tell you its purpose?

Understanding and Using Adjectives and Noun Modifiers

Form: Adjective + Noun Combinations

Identify the adjective + noun combinations in the following sentence.

"San Diego's East County wilderness is one of the most diverse areas in the county featuring rolling hills, majestic mountains, sparkling lakes, deep canyons, and desert landscapes plus Indian casino gaming."

Adjectives: diverse, rolling, majestic, sparkling, deep, desert

Nouns: areas, hills, mountains, lakes, canyons, landscapes.

- What is the rule for adjective + noun word order?
 - DETERMINER + ADJECTIVE + NOUN
 - Examples: a sparkling lake, some rolling hills, the majestic mountains

Form: Noun Modifiers

In this sentence, which word tells us 'what kind of sports?'

People use lakes for water sports.

Both the word water and the word sports are nouns. But water is telling us what kind of sports.

In this phrase, sports is the head (or main) noun, and water is the noun modifier.

Find the noun and noun modifier in this sentence.

San Diego has many beautiful golf courses.

golf= noun modifier

courses= head noun

Meaning: Adjectives and Noun Modifiers

Read the two paragraphs below. Which paragraph is more interesting? Which paragraph makes you want to visit East County? Why? Discuss with your classmates and instructor.

- In addition to outdoor adventures, East San Diego County boasts plenty of entertainment. Sizzling Las Vegas-style Native American casinos, luxurious resorts tucked right into the rugged landscape, challenging golf courses built around natural obstacles, historic sites and highways, and annual festivals and rodeos can be enjoyed, all within the expansive landscape of this California wilderness country.
- In addition to adventures, East San Diego County has entertainment. Casinos, resorts, golf courses, site and highways, and festivals and rodeos can be enjoyed, all within the landscape of this country.

In the first paragraph above, identify the words that are missing in the second paragraph

- Why do we use adjectives in a composition? Choose all that apply...
 - To add interesting details
 - To convince the reader that something is good or bad
 - To help the reader make a picture in their mind
 - Other (please specify)
- What is the usual word order for adjective and noun combinations?
 - (Article) + adjective + noun
 - (Article) + noun + adjective

Vocabulary

Descriptive Adjectives

Examine the text of "Welcome to East County." For each adjective in the first list, write the noun that follows. Then match the phrase in the first list with the words in the second list that show its meaning...

- Outdoor _____
- Luxurious _____
- Rugged _____
- Sharp _____
- Challenging _____
- Vast _____
- Diverse _____
- Natural _____
- Historic _____
- Annual _____
- Favorite _____
- Friendly _____
- Places that different a lot from each other
- A very big natural place
- A big and clear difference
- Fun activities outside
- Parties that happen every year in a town or city
- An area in nature like a mountain or forest that is wild and difficult to walk in

- A place to play the game of golf that is fun and difficult
- A village or place that has an interesting history
- A village where people smile and talk to each other
- A thing in nature that blocks the way
- A preferred journey to take for just a day
- Expensive and beautiful hotels

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2.2: Writing: Promotional Language

Use these activities to analyze and practice the promotional language in the tourist blurb “Welcome to East County.”

This lesson is available as a [worksheet](#).

Find the following phrases in the blurb “[Welcome to East County](#)” and highlight them. Then complete the sentences on this worksheet.

- The area offers _____
- Spend an afternoon _____
- Don't miss _____
- _____ is famous for _____

Write the grammatical structure that follows each of these phrases...

- The area offers + _____
- Spend an afternoon + _____
- Don't miss + _____
- _____ is famous for + _____

Write two sentences about each of the following places. Start each sentence with one of the four phrases above.



- Old Town, San Diego, CA
 - EX: Old Town offers shopping, historical sites, and great restaurants.



- Ocean Beach, CA
 - EX: Spend an afternoon surfing the waves, throwing a ball for your pooch at dog's beach, or sampling excellent vegan food at one of Ocean Beach's excellent cafes.



- Little Italy, San Diego, CA
 - Don't miss the weekly farmer's market every Saturday 8am - 2pm.

Look back at the “[Welcome to East County](#)” webpage. Are there any other phrases you could use in your own tourist blurb?

Attribution

Worksheet created by Brittany Zemmlick, Grossmont College. Adapted by Sara Ferguson.

Photo credits

Figure 1 https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Old_town,_San_Diego,_CA,_USA.jpg

Figure 2 <https://www.flickr.com/photos/michael-seljos/3627453311>

Figure 3 https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Little_Italy,_San_Diego.jpg

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2.3: Randall's Listening Lab: The Four Seasons

Listening Activity

In this activity you will listen to a student speech about the seasons and check your understanding with comprehension questions.

Pre-listening vocabulary

Do you know these words? Put a check next to the words you know, and be prepared to tell or show your classmates their meaning.

- Cold
- Hot
- Humid
- Dry
- Windy
- Pleasant
- Cool
- Snowy
- Breezy

Listen to a Student Speech

Listen to [this recording](#) and answer the questions that follow on the website. Then discuss or write the answers to the questions below.

- What are the four seasons?
- What special outdoor activities do people like to do in your city in each of the four seasons? Use the suggested pattern.
 - In the _____, people like to _____.
 - EX: In the summer, people like to go surfing in the Pacific Ocean
 - Use the following vocabulary, and then add three words or phrases of your own...
 - Hike
 - Stroll
 - Fly kites
 - Picnic
 - Sledding
 - Visit _____
 - Sunbathe
 - Surf
 - _____
 - _____
 - _____
 - Some of these verbs can use the pattern "go" + _____-ing. Which ones? Example: go hiking

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2.4: Reading an ESL Reader: BC Festivals

All Together Now: BC Festivals

In places across British Columbia, people come together for festivals that celebrate the things that make their hometown special.



Figure 2.4.1: Vancouver Island

Every year, about 20,000 grey whales swim past the west coast of Vancouver Island. The whales travel from Mexico to the Arctic and back again. The whole trip is about 16,000 kilometres. This is one of the longest yearly journeys of any mammal. Each March, the people who live around the Pacific Rim National Park hold a festival to celebrate the whales' journey. The festival is known as the Pacific Rim Whale Festival. The whales travel very close to the shore as they swim north. This allows people to gather together to watch them from land as well as from boats.



Figure 2.4.2: Bathtub race in Nanaimo

On the east coast of Vancouver Island, you can spot mammals of a different sort moving through the water — people in bathtub boats! The city of Nanaimo is home to the world's oldest and best-known bathtub boat race. It started out as a silly event in 1967. Today, Nanaimo's World Championship Bathtub Race is a serious sport that brings racers and visitors from around the world.



Figure 2.4.3: Dragon Boat Festival in Vancouver

Vancouver is home to another famous festival on the water — the Dragon Boat Festival. Dragon boat racing started in China over 2,000 years ago. It was brought to Vancouver during Expo 86. It returned as a yearly event in 1989 as a way to celebrate the many cultures living together in the city. The festival begins with a ceremony to awaken the dragon and give the people and boats the dragon’s strength. Each boat has a dragon’s head carved on the front and a tail on the back. The boat holds a team of about 20 people, who paddle to the beat of a drummer seated at the front.



Figure 2.4.4: Vernon

One of Canada’s largest winter festivals takes place in the Rocky Mountains of British Columbia. It’s the Vernon Winter Carnival, which is held each February. Some of the major events include a BC snow sculpture contest, sports using giant hot air balloons, and a parade. During the carnival, people can have a friend, co-worker, or boss arrested by carnival cops who then throw them in “jail” until they raise enough money for bail. All money raised goes to support the carnival.

The festivals of British Columbia are a way for the many people who live here to enjoy nature, share a laugh, and learn about one another.

word patterns

When you see the suffix –er, –or, or –ar at the end of a word, it often means “a person who”

- A baker is a person who bakes

- An actor is a person who acts
- A liar is a person who lies

Words in this story that fit this pattern are:

- Racers
- Visitors
- Drummer
- Co-worker

The suffix –est means “the most”

- Fastest means the most fast
- Strongest means the most strong
- Lightest means the most light

Words in this story that fit this pattern are:

- longest
- oldest
- largest

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2.5: Reading Strategies: BC Festivals

One way you can build your reading skills is to build your vocabulary. Your vocabulary is the group of words that you know.

You can build your vocabulary by keeping track of words that are new to you. You might see new words in newspapers or hear them on TV. Find out what they mean. Then remember and use your new words.

Learning new words helps you because_____.

- You will understand more difficult readings
- You will be able to express yourself more clearly
- You will be able to retell things in your own words

Vocabulary

Identify which words below are new to you.

- Tradition
- Celebrate
- Journey
- Kilometre
- Mammal
- National
- Championship
- Ceremony
- Festival
- Sculpture

Open or print [this worksheet](#).

Choose three words from above that you need not know. Add each word to the middle of its own "word" box on the worksheet.

Look up your three words in the dictionary. Sometimes a word has more than one meaning. The most common meaning will be given first. Under "dictionary definition," write down the most common meaning for your three words.

For each word, complete all of the other boxes on the worksheet.

Word Attack Strategy

Often, we can figure out a new word without looking in a dictionary. We can use our word attack skills.

One word attack strategy is to look for a suffix. A suffix is part of a word. It is put at the end of the word to change the meaning. In this section, you will learn about these suffixes: -er, -or, -ar, and -est

word patterns

When you see the suffix -er, -or, or -ar at the end of a word, it often means "a person who"

For example:

- A baker is a person who bakes
- An actor is a person who acts
- A liar is a person who lies

Questions

- What is a visitor?
 - A visitor is a person who _____.
- What is a racer?
 - A racer is a person who _____.

- What is a sculptor? A sculptor is a person who _____.

word patterns

The suffix –est means “the most”

For example:

- Fastest means the most fast
- Strongest means the most strong
- Lightest means the most light

Questions

- What does longest mean?
 - Longest means the most _____
- What does oldest mean?
 - Oldest means the most _____
- What does largest mean?
 - Largest means the most _____

Use Your Strategies

Think about any festivals you have been to. What did they celebrate? What kinds of events were there? Now, reread the reading *All Together Now: BC Festivals* from the previous section, 3.2

Check Your Understanding

The subject of the reading is festivals of British Columbia. The reading is divided into six paragraphs. Each paragraph is about a different, but closely related topic

Find the Topic

- What is the topic of the second paragraph?
 - Whales
 - Festivals in British Columbia
 - The Pacific Rim Whale Festival
- What is the topic of the third paragraph?
 - Bathtubs
 - Nanaimo's World Championship Bathtub Race
 - Vancouver Island
- What is the topic in the fourth paragraph?
 - The Dragon Boat Festival in Vancouver
 - Dragons
 - China
- What is the topic of the fifth paragraph?
 - The Vernon Winter Carnival
 - Sculptures
 - The Rocky Mountains

Fill in the Blanks with a Word That Makes Sense

The following words are your word bank...

- Cultures
- Journey

- Jail
- Serious
- The Pacific Rim Whale Festival celebrates the _____ of the grey whale.
- The World Championship Bathtub Race started as a silly event but is now a _____ sport.
- The Dragon Boat Festival celebrates the many different _____ of the people in Vancouver.
- At the Vernon Winter Carnival, people are put in _____ to raise money.

Grammar

If we learn the rules about capital letters, we can help our readers understand what we write. You already know to use a capital letter at the beginning of a sentence. This helps our readers understand that we are starting a new idea. Here are some more rules about capital letters...

grammar rule

Use a capital letter for...

- Names of people
- Titles of books, movies, newspapers, and so on
- Places and landmarks
- Days of the week and months of the year
- Holidays and special events
- The word "I"

Why Do These Words Have Capital Letters?

Match each word to the correct capital letter rule from the box above.

- Arctic
- Mexico
- Expo 86
- Rocky Mountains
- Nanaimo
- March
- Vernon Winter Carnival
- Dragon Boat Festival
- China
- February
- Pacific Rim National Park

These Sentences are Missing Capital Letters

Rewrite these sentences and add capital letters where needed

- albert ostman said he was kidnapped by a sasquatch.
- ginger goodwin hid on alone mountain near comox lake.
- there is a movie about bill miner called the grey fox.
- are you going to the kamloopa powwow?
- yes, i am leaving on friday, and i will be back on sunday.

Writing

Think of a festival you know about. Create a poster or ad to let people know about the event. If you want to, you can invent your own festival.

Include:

- The name of the festival
- Details about the events
- The dates
- The address

You can make up the details, such as where and when the next one will take place.

When you have finished.

- Check that you used capital letters correctly.
- Use the dictionary to check your spelling.
- Hand it in to your instructor.

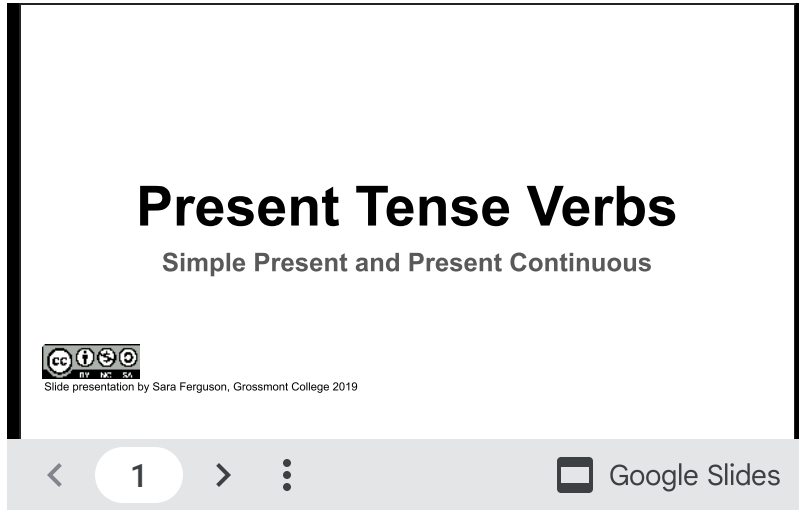
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2.6: Grammar: Present Tense Verbs

This lesson is available as [slides](#) for classroom presentation.



Present Tense Verbs

Simple Present and Present Continuous

 Slide presentation by Sara Ferguson, Grossmont College 2019

< 1 > ⋮ Google Slides

Warm-Up

Compare these sentences.

- Every day, I travel from Tijuana to San Diego
- Right now, I am driving to Grossmont College

Study the verbs. What is the difference between the two tenses?

Simple Present and Present Continuous Forms

Present Simple

- Something, that is always true
- Daily routes
- Something that happens regularly

positive statements

I	eat
you	eat
he	<u>eats</u>
she	<u>eats</u>
it	<u>eats</u>
we	eat
you	eat
they	eat

negative statements

I	don't	eat
you	don't	eat
he	<u>doesn't</u>	eat
she	<u>doesn't</u>	eat
it	<u>doesn't</u>	eat
we	don't	eat
you	don't	eat
they	don't	eat

questions

do	I	eat ?
do	you	eat ?
<u>does</u>	he	eat ?
<u>does</u>	she	eat ?
<u>does</u>	it	eat ?
do	we	eat ?
do	you	eat ?
do	they	eat ?

Present Continuous

- Something, that is just happening
- Something that is true only now or about now
- Describing pictures

positive statements

I	am	<u>eating</u>
you	are	<u>eating</u>
he	is	<u>eating</u>
she	is	<u>eating</u>
it	is	<u>eating</u>
we	are	<u>eating</u>
you	are	<u>eating</u>
they	are	<u>eating</u>

negative statements

I	m' not	<u>eating</u>
you	aren't	<u>eating</u>
he	isn't	<u>eating</u>
she	isn't	<u>eating</u>
it	isn't	<u>eating</u>
we	aren't	<u>eating</u>
you	aren't	<u>eating</u>
they	aren't	<u>eating</u>

questions

am	I	<u>eating</u> ?
are	you	<u>eating</u> ?
is	he	<u>eating</u> ?
is	she	<u>eating</u> ?
is	it	<u>eating</u> ?
are	we	<u>eating</u> ?
are	you	<u>eating</u> ?
are	they	<u>eating</u> ?

Figure 2.6.1

Spelling Rules for Adding -ing to a Verb (Present Participle)

NO CHANGE	<u>Most verbs</u> Add -ing	Read--Reading Talk--Talking Say--Saying Want--Wanting
NO CHANGE	<u>Verbs that end in -y</u> Add -ing	Study--Studying Carry--Carrying Play--Playing
CHANGE	<u>Verbs that add in -e</u> Drop the -e and add -ing	Wake—Waking Make—Making Tape--Taping
CHANGE	<u>Verbs that end in -ie</u> Change the ie to y	Die—dying Lie—lying
CHANGE	<u>Verbs that end in CVC (consonant, vowel, consonant)</u> <u>1 syllable</u> Double the last letter	Stop—Stopping Sit—Sitting Ban--Banning
CHANGE	<u>Verbs that end in CVC</u> <u>2 syllables</u> If the stress is on the last syllable, double the last letter	Begin—Beginning Refer—Referring BUT Listen—Listening Cancel--Canceling

Spelling Rules for Adding -s/-es to the End of a Word (Plural Noun or Third Person Singular Simple Present)

Most words Add -s to the end of the word	Verbs Walk--Walks Cook--Cooks Sit--Sits Run--Runs	Plural nouns Hat--Hats Table--Tables Chair--Chairs Tree--Trees
Words ending in consonant -y Change the -y to -ie, then add -s	Verbs Carry--Carries Study--Studies Fly--Flies	Plural Nouns Sky--Skies Belly--Bellies Rally--Rallies
Words ending in these consonants S X Ch Sh Add -es	Verbs Pass--Passes Fix—Fixes Watch—Watches Bash--Bashes	Plural Nouns Mess—Messes Tax—Taxes Patch--Patches Dish—Dishes

Simple Present Tense Usage

- General facts
 - EX: It never snows in El Cajon
- Routines/habits
 - EX: She drives from Mexico to San Diego once a week
- Permanent situations

- EX: I live in San Diego
- Stative verbs
 - EX: I don't like the weather in San Diego

Present Continuous Usage

- Actions that are happening right now
 - EX: We are strolling on the beach
- Actions that are in progress
 - EX: This semester, she is working at a restaurant to help pay for school
- Actions that are new or temporary
 - EX: He is living in San Diego; he moved here a few months ago
- Actions that are changing over time
 - EX: Rent in San Diego is increasing rapidly

Contrasting Simple Present and Present Continuous

Simple present is used for permanent situations. Present continuous is used for situations that are new or temporary.

- She works at Ross Dress for Less; she has worked there for a while and plans to stay
- She is working at Ross Dress for Less; she started the job a short time ago, or she plans to change jobs soon

Some verbs are stative. This means they are usually used for a permanent situation. Some of these verbs cannot be used in continuous form; other stative verbs change meaning when they are used in continuous form.

- GOOD EX: I own a car
- BAD EX: I am owning a car
- GOOD EX: I think Balboa Park is beautiful
- BAD EX: I am thinking Balboa Park is beautiful
- GOOD EX: I am thinking about Balboa Park

Learn How to Form Simple Present

Watch [this video](#).

Learn How to Form Present Continuous

Watch [this video](#).

Learn About the Differences Between Simple Present and Present Continuous

Watch [this video](#).

Learn More About Stative Verbs

Watch [this video](#).

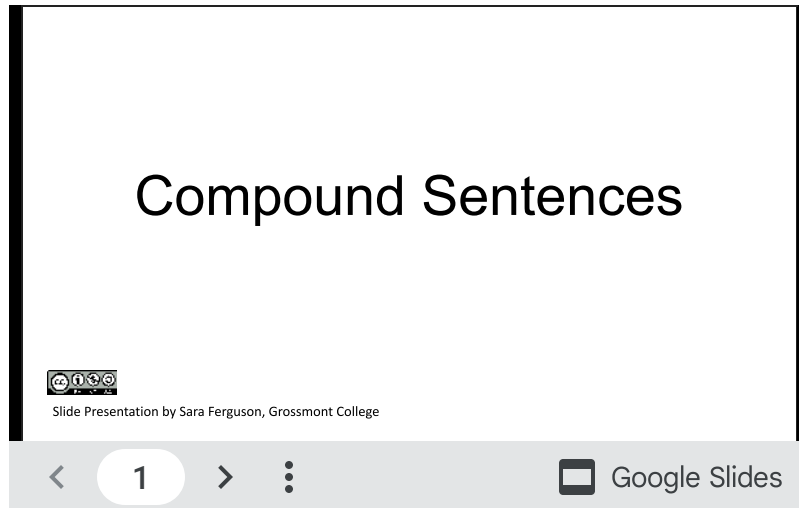
[Click here](#) for lists and exercises for learning more about stative verbs.

[Click here](#) for a list of stative verbs.

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2.7: Grammar: Compound Sentences

This lesson is available as [slides](#) for classroom presentation.



Subjects and Verbs

Read these sentences about the history of San Diego. Identify the subject and verb of each sentence. How many subjects and verbs does each sentence have?

- Spanish explorers sailed to San Diego in 1542, but the first residents were Kumeyaay people
- In 1821, Mexico won independence from Spain, and San Diego became part of Mexico
- In 1848, the United States won the Mexican-American War, so San Diego became part of the U.S.

Answers

- The subjects were "Spanish explorers" and "the first residents," the verbs were "sailed" and "were"
- The subjects were "Mexico" and "San Diego," the verbs were "won" and "became"
- The subjects were "the United States" and "San Diego," the verbs were "won" and "became"

Notice the punctuation. Where is the comma?

Clauses and Coordinating Conjunctions

A group of words that has a subject and verb is called a clause

Two or more simple sentences (clauses) may be connected to make one sentence using a comma and a coordinating conjunction

Coordinating conjunctions are also called FANBOYS. The FANBOYS are...

- For
- And
- Nor
- But
- Or
- Yet
- So

Compound Sentences

When two or more clauses are connected with a FANBOYS, the sentence is called a compound sentence

A compound sentence must have two independent clauses (SV + SV) connected by a FANBOYS

Look at the sentences below. Identify the subjects and verbs. These are not compound sentences...

- The San Diego Zoo and Balboa Park began in 1915
- Every weekend we go to the beach and enjoy the water

Answers

- The subjects were "San Diego Zoo" and "Balboa Park," the verb was "began," (compound subject)
- The subject was "we," the verbs were "go" and "enjoy," (compound verb)

Watch [this video](#) for another explanation of compound sentences.

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2.8: Grammar: Descriptive Adjectives

This lesson includes [slides for classroom presentation](#).



What is an Adjective?

An adjective modifies a noun. In other words, it gives more information about the noun, such as what kind, how many, or which one. Look at the phrases below and identify the adjective and noun...

- Rolling hills
- Majestic mountains
- Sparkling lakes

Answers

- The adjective was "rolling," the noun was "hills"
- The adjective was "majestic," the noun was mountains
- The adjective was "sparkling," the noun was "lakes"

Descriptive Adjectives

Descriptive adjectives can appear in two places in the sentence. Find the adjectives in these sentences...

- San Diego has sandy beaches
- The beaches in Sand Diego are sandy

Answers

- The descriptive adjective (sandy) comes before the noun (beaches)
- The descriptive adjective (sandy) comes after the linking verb (are)

Recognizing and Creating Adjectives

There are many adjectives in English. Adjectives make your writing more interesting, vivid, and rich. Add adjectives to your vocabulary by using them as you learn them. You can also sometimes recognize adjectives by their endings...

- -able/ible; incredible, doable, readable
- -ful; helpful, restful, doubtful
- -less; restless, helpless, doubtless
- -ic; alcoholic, realistic
- -ive; creative, active
- -al; natural, practical

- -ous; suspicious, decorous
- -ish; childish, impish

Adjectives can also be created from verbs. Some past participles and present participles can be used as adjectives...

Verb	Past participle adjective	Present participle adjective
Interest	Interested	Interesting
Tire	Tired	Tiring
Amaze	Amazed	Amazing
Fascinate	Fascinated	Fascinating
Bore	Bored	Boring

Past and Present Participle Adjectives

Past participle adjectives such as "bored," "amazed," and "interested" show that someone experiences that situation

- EX: She felt excited (she experienced excitement)

Present participle adjectives such as "boring," "amazing," and "interesting" show that the noun causes that verb

- EX: The movie was amazing (the movie caused excitement)

Examples

- Verb: Frighten
 - EX: The mask is frightening. I feel frightened when I look at the mask
- Verb: Interest
 - EX: I am interested in the history of Iraq. Iraq has an interesting history
- Verb: Confuse
 - EX: The homework is confusing. All of the students felt confused by the homework
- Verb: Excite
 - EX: Disneyland is exciting. My kids are so excited about going to Disneyland

Adjective Order

Adjectives usually follow a specific order in English. The order is below...

- Determiner: A/an/the, this/that/these/those, my/your/his/her/our/their, many/both/some... etc.
- Opinion: Beautiful, ugly, hard-working, useful... etc.
- Size: Large, small, tiny, huge... etc.
- Age: Old, vintage, new, brand-new... etc.
- Shape: Round, long, thin, square... etc.
- Color: Blue, yellow, gray... etc.
- Origin: Italian, Mexican, Chinese... etc.
- Material: Woolen, cotton, wooden... etc.
- Purpose: Wedding, sleeping, swimming... etc.

It's unusual to use more than two or three adjectives before a noun

Try describing a dress, a car, and a mountain. Use at least two adjectives in the correct order. You can use adjectives from below or write your own...

- A _____ dress
- A _____ car

- A _____ mountain

Adjectives To Choose From

- Blue
- Huge
- Beautiful
- Vintage
- Italian
- Gray
- New
- Small
- Square
- Ugly
- Hard-working
- Brand-new
- Yellow
- Useful
- Fast
- Tiny
- Long
- Mexican
- Large
- Wedding
- Majestic
- Lace
- Chinese
- Old

Comparative Adjectives

Compare two nouns using a comparative adjective. Which two nouns are compared in these sentences? What is the comparative adjective?

- San Diego, CA is larger than El Cajon, CA
- Black Mountain is higher than Mount Helix

Answers

- The two nouns are "San Diego, CA" and "El Cajon, CA" and the comparative adjective is "larger"
- The two nouns are "Black Mountain" and "Mount Helix" and the comparative adjective is "higher"

Did you notice what word follows the comparative adjective?

Answer

- Than

How Do We Make Comparative Adjectives?

One-syllable adjectives	Two-syllable adjectives ending with -y	Two-or-more-syllable adjectives	Irregular adjectives
Larger	Easier	More diverse	Good-better
Richer	Happier	More difficult	Far-farther/further
Deeper	Hungrier	More majestic	Little-less
Higher	Curlier	More populated	Many-more
Smaller			Bad-worse
Bigger			

- If the word is one syllable, add -er to the end of the word
- If the word ends with -e, add -r
- If the word is one syllable and ends with CVC (consonant-vowel-consonant), double the final consonant
- If the word is two syllables, use "more" + adjective
- If the word is two syllables and ends with -y, drop the -y and add -ier
- Comparative adjectives are followed by "than"

Videos

- Watch [this video](#) for a clear definition of adjectives...
- Watch [this video](#) for more details about adjectives...

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2.9: Assignment: Write a Persuasive Email

Write a persuasive email. Choose one prompt below.

- Write an email to a friend or family member. Persuade them to visit you in a place you know well.
- Write to a friend or family member. Persuade them to move to a place you know well.

Before you Write

1. Make a list of places you know well. Choose the nicest place on your list. It can be a city, country, neighborhood or even your house!
2. Make a list of aspects your friend/family member will like about this place. It could be the sights, the activities, the weather, festivals or the culture.
3. Decide whether you will persuade your friend to visit or move to your place.

Writing Checklist

Is your genre clear? Does your email have_____?

- An email address to your friend or family member. It does not have to be a real address.
- A subject line that tell the main idea of the email. It should be short and specific.
- A friendly greeting to your friend or family member.
- A signature line with your name at the end.

Is the purpose of your email clear? It should have_____

- a clear topic. The place you are writing about should be obvious!
- A clear purpose. Are you inviting a friend for a vacation or persuading them to move?
- a positive tone.
- at least five positive descriptive adjectives. Make one of them a comparative adjective to show how much better your place is.

Is your audience for the email clear? The email should have_____

- a friendly, informal tone for your friend or family member.

Have you checked your grammar, spelling, capitalization and punctuation? Check_____

- Commas in your compound sentences and periods at the ends of sentences.
- Capitalization.
- Spelling, especially vocabulary words in this chapter
- Word order for adjective noun combinations
- Simple present tense verb form

Grade Rubric

Criteria	Description	Points Possible
Content	The email persuades the recipient to visit a place as a tourist or move there. The tone is positive, and there are enough details to sell the place.	
Genre/audience/purpose	The text is an email. It has a subject line, email address, greeting, signature line, and the content is addressed to the recipient. The tone is appropriate for the recipient. The audience, purpose, and selected place (topic) are all clear.	
Vocabulary	The word choice makes the place seem attractive. The word choice is varied and not repetitive. Word form is accurate. Student uses appropriate phrases from mentor texts.	
Grammar and mechanics	The email uses at least five descriptive adjectives accurately. At least one of those adjectives is comparative. The grammar has been edited for accuracy.	

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

3: Push and Pull Factors

Learning Objectives

After completing Chapter 3, students will be able to

1. Read and analyze the main ideas and details of a chapter from a history textbook about the Great Northward Migration.
2. Practice reading strategies for challenging academic texts such as pre-reading, skimming, and summarizing.
3. Build vocabulary in the domain of African-American history.
4. Analyze main ideas and details of an adapted sidebar from a sociology textbook about culture shock.
5. Use vocabulary to discuss personal experiences of culture shock.
6. Identify past tense verbs.
7. Identify adverbs and their meaning.
8. Use comparative and superlative adjectives and adverbs to describe a place.

[3.1: Reading a Textbook: The Great Migration](#)

[3.2: Reading: Culture Shock](#)

[3.3: Grammar: Adverbs](#)

[3.4: Grammar: Identifying the Past Tense](#)

[3.5: Grammar: Comparative and Superlative Adjectives and Adverbs](#)

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3.1: Reading a Textbook: The Great Migration

Pre-Reading Activities

The chapter you will be reading from the textbook discusses the migration of African Americans from the South to Northern cities. Answer the questions below to begin thinking about the ideas in the chapter.

- What do you know already about the history of African Americans in the U.S.?
- When you moved to the United States, what pulled you here?
- When you moved to the United States, what pushed you away from your home country?

Vocabulary Preview

Identify the words below that you already know. Discuss them with your classmates or instructor, or look them up in the dictionary.

- Migration
- Rural
- Historical
- Factor
- Civil War
- Push
- Slavery
- Racism
- Lynching
- Flee/fled
- Vote
- Violence
- Pull

First Reading

When reading a challenging academic text, you will often need to read several times to understand the full meaning. Read through the text one time quickly (skim) to find the main idea. After you read once, write a few notes. What is one thing you remember from your first reading? What is one question you have from your first reading? Your first reading should take only a few minutes; don't try to understand every word, just try to understand the general idea of the text.

The African American "Great Migration": Section One

Between the end of the Civil War (1865) and the beginning of the Great Depression (1929), almost two million African Americans moved from the rural South to look for new opportunities. While some moved west, most of this Great Migration, as the large number of African Americans leaving the South was called, moved to the Northeast and Upper Midwest. More than two-thirds of them moved to the following cities: New York, Chicago, Philadelphia, St. Louis, Detroit, Pittsburgh, Cleveland, and Indianapolis

The African American "Great Migration": Section Two

There are “push” and “pull” factors for any migration (the movement of a large number of people). Even though the Civil War had ended and laws were passed to end slavery and protect the right to vote, African Americans still experienced intense racism. Groups like the Ku Klux Klan caused death threats, violence, and lynchings (murder by hanging). According to researchers at the Tuskegee Institute, there were thirty-five hundred lynchings and other murders committed in the South between 1865 and 1900. For African Americans fleeing this violence, northern and midwestern cities offered an opportunity to escape the dangers of the South.

The African American "Great Migration": Section Three

In addition to this “push” out of the South, African Americans were also “pulled” to the cities by job opportunities and the chance to vote (for men, at least). Many African Americans did not have money to move themselves, but factory owners and other businesses helped pay for their moves. Because of racism, African American workers still had the lower-paying jobs in steel mills, mines, construction, and meat packing. In the railroad industry, they often worked as porters or servants. In other businesses, they

worked as janitors, waiters, or cooks. African American women, who faced racism and sexism, often worked as maids and domestic servants. Nevertheless, African Americans earned higher wages in the North than they did for the same jobs in the South, and found housing more easily.

The African American "Great Migration": Section Four

However, life in the city was still difficult. African Americans still experienced the higher cost of living in the North, especially in terms of rent and food. As a result, housing was often overcrowded and dirty. They still experienced racism from landlords, bankers and neighbors. So why move to the North, since the economic problems were similar to those in the South? African Americans moved for non-economic gains. In the North they found greater educational opportunities and personal freedom. Similarly, unlike the South where African Americans often experienced violence, life in larger, crowded cities permitted African Americans to move, work, and speak freely.

Second Reading

Read the chapter a second time. This time, stop and answer the comprehension questions after each section. Take notes.

The African American "Great Migration": Section One

Between the end of the Civil War (1865) and the beginning of the Great Depression (1929), almost two million African Americans moved from the rural South to look for new opportunities. While some moved west, most of this Great Migration, as the large number of African Americans leaving the South was called, moved to the Northeast and Upper Midwest. More than two-thirds of them moved to the following cities: New York, Chicago, Philadelphia, St. Louis, Detroit, Pittsburgh, Cleveland, and Indianapolis

Comprehension Questions

- How many African Americans moved away from the South from 1865 to 1929?
- What is the name of this large historical movement?
- On the map of the U.S. at the end of this chapter, identify the 8 cities mentioned in the paragraph above. Which part of the U.S. is the South?

The African American "Great Migration": Section Two

There are "push" and "pull" factors for any migration (the movement of a large number of people). Even though the Civil War had ended and laws were passed to end slavery and protect the right to vote, African Americans still experienced intense racism. Groups like the Ku Klux Klan caused death threats, violence, and lynchings (murder by hanging). According to researchers at the Tuskegee Institute, there were thirty-five hundred lynchings and other murders committed in the South between 1865 and 1900. For African Americans fleeing this violence, northern and midwestern cities offered an opportunity to escape the dangers of the South.

Comprehension Questions

- What is the "push" factor that caused African Americans to leave the South?
- How many African Americans were murdered in the South between 1865 and 1900?

The African American "Great Migration": Section Three

In addition to this "push" out of the South, African Americans were also "pulled" to the cities by job opportunities and the chance to vote (for men, at least). Many African Americans did not have money to move themselves, but factory owners and other businesses helped pay for their moves. Because of racism, African American workers still had the lower-paying jobs in steel mills, mines, construction, and meat packing. In the railroad industry, they often worked as porters or servants. In other businesses, they worked as janitors, waiters, or cooks. African American women, who faced racism and sexism, often worked as maids and domestic servants. Nevertheless, African Americans earned higher wages in the North than they did for the same jobs in the South, and found housing more easily.

Comprehension Questions

- What are three "pull" factors that caused African Americans to move to Northern cities?

The African American "Great Migration": Section Four

However, life in the city was still difficult. African Americans still experienced the higher cost of living in the North, especially in terms of rent and food. As a result, housing was often overcrowded and dirty. They still experienced racism from landlords, bankers and neighbors. So why move to the North, since the economic problems were similar to those in the South? African Americans moved for non-economic gains. In the North they found greater educational opportunities and personal freedom. Similarly, unlike the South where African Americans often experienced violence, life in larger, crowded cities permitted African Americans to move, work, and speak freely.

Comprehension Questions

- What were two non-economic gains from African Americans who moved to Northern cities?
- Why was life in the city still different for African Americans?

Genre and Reading Strategies

Identify the best answer for each question or fill in the blank.

- The tone of this textbook chapter is _____.
 - Formal
 - Informal
- In order to understand and remember the information in this textbook chapter, I read it _____ times.
- I skimmed this chapter before I read it slowly.
 - Yes
 - No
- Information about the Civil War is in Section _____.
- The definition of the Great Migration is in Section _____.
- When I take notes, it _____.
 - Helps me understand and remember
 - Doesn't help me understand and remember

Summary Writing

One way to understand the remember information from an academic textbook is to write a summary of the chapter after you read it. There are four sections in the chapter. Before you write, re-read the section. Then cover the text and tell your classmates what the section is about. Try to explain it clearly in one sentence. After you have explained the main idea out loud, write one sentence that gives the main idea for each section. Section One is written for you as an example.

Section One

From 1865 to 1929, 2 million African Americans moved from the South to the North.

Discuss or Write

The textbook chapter discusses the "push" and "pull" factors that caused African Americans to migrate from the South to Northern cities. Identify those factors. Are any of those factors similar to your own reasons for immigrating to your current home?

Vocabulary Activity

Match the vocabulary terms in the first list with the matching synonyms or definition in the second list...

1. Migration (n)
2. Rural (adj)
3. Historical (adj)
4. Factor (n)
5. Civil War (proper noun)
6. Slavery (n)

7. Racism (n)
 8. Lynching (n)
 9. Flee (v)
 10. Vote (v)
 11. Violence (n)
 12. Push (v)
 13. Pull (v)
- Related to history; the past
 - Murder by hanging without a trial; a form of terrorism
 - The movement of a large group of people from one area to another
 - Hatred or discrimination toward someone based on race
 - Countryside; the opposite of city
 - To force away
 - To force toward
 - A condition where some people own others as property and force them to work
 - A circumstance that causes a result
 - The war between the North and the South in the U.S., 1861-1865
 - To escape; to run away
 - Formally choose between people or actions; cast a ballot
 - The use of physical force to cause harm

Map of the U.S.



Figure 3.1.1

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3.2: Reading: Culture Shock

Pre-Reading Activities

Discuss or write about these questions with your instructor and classmates.

- How did you feel on the first day you arrived in the U.S.? Did your feelings change over time?
- What are some differences you noticed right away between behavior in your country and behavior in the U.S.?

Vocabulary Preview

Identify which of the following words and phrases you know. Be ready to explain the words to your classmates.

- Taboo
- Cultural
- Norm
- Custom
- Signal
- Gesture
- Culture
- Shock
- Adjust

Sociology in the Real World: Overcoming Culture Shock

During her summer vacation, Caitlin flew from Chicago, Illinois to Madrid, Spain to visit Maria, the friend she met last semester. In the airport, she heard rapid, musical Spanish all around her. It was exciting, but she felt alone and uncomfortable. Maria's mother kissed Caitlin on both cheeks when she greeted her, and Caitlin was surprised. Caitlin was almost asleep by dinner time -- at 10 p.m.! Maria's family sat at the table for hours. They spoke loudly and they argued about politics, a taboo dinner topic in Caitlin's house. They served wine and toasted their honored guest. Caitlin didn't understand her hosts' facial expressions, and didn't know that she should make the next toast. That night, Caitlin crawled into a strange bed, and she wanted to go home. She felt overwhelmed by the new customs, language, and surroundings.

What Caitlin didn't know was that people use not only spoken words but also subtle cues like gestures and facial expressions, to communicate. Cultural norms accompany even the smallest nonverbal signals (DuBois 1951). They help people know when to shake hands, where to sit, how to converse, and even when to laugh. We relate to others through shared cultural norms, and ordinarily, we don't even notice them. For this reason, culture shock often happens when traveling to a new country, although it can happen in one's own country, state, or even hometown. Anthropologist Kalervo Oberg (1960) first coined the term "culture shock." In his studies, Oberg found that most people who visited a new country felt excited at first, but over time, they became stressed by interacting with people from a different culture who spoke another language. There was new food, new daily schedules, and new rules of etiquette. Living with this constant stress can make people feel incompetent and nervous. After two weeks in Spain, Caitlin understood that adjusting to a new culture takes time. It can take weeks or months to recover from culture shock, and it can take years to fully adjust to living in a new culture. During her trip, she made new lifelong friends. She learned a lot about Spain, but she also discovered a lot about herself and her own culture.

Glossary

- Taboo (n)- something that is not acceptable to talk about or do
- Toast (v)- to compliment someone, and then take a drink
- Facial expressions (n. phrase)- the way feelings show on someone's face
- Overwhelmed (adj)- to have too many things to deal with
- Custom (n)- a way of behaving that is usual or traditional in a culture
- Subtle cues (n. phrase)- signals that are hard to see
- Gestures (n)- movement of the body

- Cultural norms (n. phrase)- ways of behaving that are normal and acceptable in a culture
- Nonverbal (adj)- without speaking
- Culture shock (n. phrase)- a feeling of confusion, doubt or nervousness caused by being in a new place (such as a foreign country)
- Stress (n), stressed (adj)- tension and worry
- Incompetent (adj)- not having important abilities or skills
- Adjust (v)- to change in order to do better in a new situation

Main Ideas, Details, and Genre

Check your understanding of the text by answering the questions below.

- What is the topic of this text?
 - Visiting Madrid, Spain
 - Caitlin and her travels
 - Culture shock
 - Culture
- A person would probably read this textbook chapter in a _____ class.
- How does the chapter explain culture shock?
 - By giving the important history of culture shock
 - By telling a story that shows what culture shock is, and showing why it happens
 - By discussing the advantages and disadvantages of culture shock
 - By advising the reader not to get culture shock
- What are three different cultural norms Caitlin noticed on her first day in Spain?
- How did Caitlin feel by the end of her first day?
- Why do people feel culture shock?
 - They did not learn the language before they moved
 - They like their own culture better than the new culture where they moved
 - People in the new culture are rude and do not accept immigrants
 - Differences in cultural norms are hard to understand, and make people feel stressed, alone, and overwhelmed

Vocabulary Practice

With classmates, write the answers to the questions below. Discuss first, then write your answers.

- What are several examples of taboos in your culture?
- Do people make a toast in your culture? If so, what do they say before they drink?
- What facial expressions do people make when they are happy? angry?
- Give an example of a time you felt overwhelmed.
- What are three customs you follow from your culture?
- Have you experienced culture shock? What did it feel like?
- What are some things people can do to adjust quickly to a new culture?

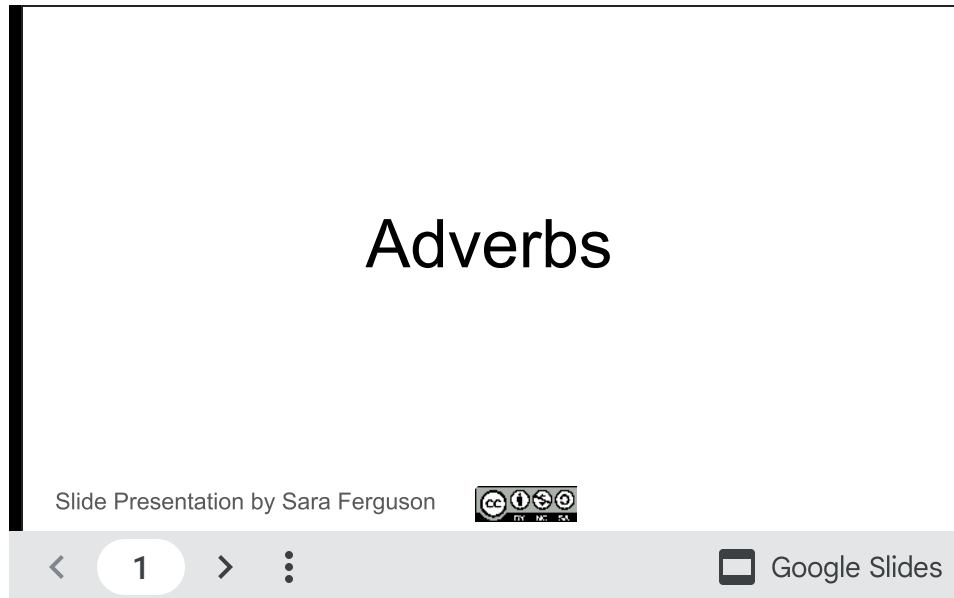
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3.3: Grammar: Adverbs

This lesson includes [slides for classroom presentation](#).



What is an Adverb?

Read the sentences below and identify the adverbs. The adverbs are giving more information (modifying) about certain words or phrases in the sentence. Which ones?

- San Diego has a very diverse population
- Immigrants to San Diego don't always speak English
- Fortunately, they are learning English
- The students in this class are learning English very quickly

Answers

- The adverb is "very" and it is modifying "diverse"
- The adverb is "always" and it is modifying "speak"
- The adverb is "fortunately" and it is modifying "they are learning English"
- The adverb is "very quickly" and it is modifying "are learning"

Why Use Adverbs?

Compare these sentences. Which sentence in each pair gives more information? What kind of information do we learn?

- Immigrants are learning English
- Fortunately, immigrants are learning English
 - Answer: In the second sentence, we learn the author's opinion
- The students in this class are learning English
- The students in this class are learning English very quickly
 - Answer: In the second sentence, we learn how the students are learning
- San Diego has nice beaches
- San Diego has incredibly nice beaches
 - Answer: In the second sentence, we learn that the beaches are not just nice but incredibly nice

Examples

Read the phrases below. What are the parts of speech of the words/phrases that are modified?

- Very diverse
- Always speak
- Fortunately, they are learning English
- Are learning very quickly
- Very quickly

Answers

- "Diverse" is an adjective
- "Speak" is a verb
- "They are learning English" is a clause
- "Are learning" is a verb
- "Quickly" is an adverb

From the example, we can say an adverb can modify a verb, a clause, an adjective, or another adverb

Read the list of adverbs below. What is a common ending for many adverbs (but not all)?

- Incredibly
- Always
- Happily
- Angrily
- Quickly
- Fast
- Early
- Never
- Sometimes
- Often
- Usually
- Sadly
- Fortunately
- Rarely
- Delightedly
- Hungrily
- Basically
- Definitely
- Probably
- Possibly
- Too
- Unfortunately
- Luckily
- Certainly
- Hardly
- Quietly

Many adverbs end with -ly. Sometimes an adverb can be created from an adjective + -ly (e.g. quick, quickly)

Adverbs of Frequency

Adverbs of frequency are used to tell how often something happens. These adverbs are usually used with simple present or simple past verbs. Which of the adverbs on the list below can be used with this sentence to give information about "how often"?

- I _____ eat breakfast
- Incredibly
- Always
- Happily
- Angrily
- Quickly
- Fast
- Early
- Never
- Sometimes
- Often
- Usually
- Sadly
- Fortunately
- Seldom
- Rarely
- Delightedly
- Hungrily
- Basically
- Definitely
- Probably
- Possibly
- Too
- Unfortunately
- Luckily
- Certainly
- Hardly
- Quietly
- Frequently
- Occasionally

Answers

- Always
- Often
- Frequently
- Usually
- Sometimes
- Occasionally
- Seldom
- Rarely
- Never

Adverbs of Manner

Adverbs of manner answer the question of "how." Adverbs of manner modify verbs and usually come after the verb. Which of the adverbs on the list below may be used in the sentences below to show how she walked or ate?

- She walked _____
- She ate _____
- Incredibly
- Always

- Happily
- Angrily
- Quickly
- Fast
- Early
- Never
- Sometimes
- Often
- Usually
- Sadly
- Fortunately
- Rarely
- Delightedly
- Hungrily
- Basically
- Definitely
- Probably
- Possibly
- Too
- Unfortunately
- Luckily
- Certainly
- Hardly
- Quietly

Answers

- Happily
- Angrily
- Quickly
- Fast
- Sadly
- Delightedly
- Hungrily
- Quietly

Comment Adverbs

Comment adverbs give the speaker's opinion about the sentence. These adverbs usually come before the sentence and are followed by a comma. Which of the adverbs on the list below can fill in the blank to show the author's opinion about arriving before the concert?

- _____, we arrived before the concert began
- Incredibly
- Always
- Happily
- Angrily
- Quickly
- Fast
- Early
- Never
- Sometimes

- Often
- usually
- Sadly
- Fortunately
- Rarely
- Delightedly
- Hungrily
- Basically
- Definitely
- Probably
- Possibly
- Too
- Unfortunately
- Luckily
- Certainly
- Hardly
- Quietly

Answers

- Incredibly
- Sadly
- Fortunately
- Basically
- Unfortunately
- Luckily
- Certainly

Videos

Watch these videos for more information about adverbs...

- [What Are Adverbs?](#)
- [What is an Adverb?](#)

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3.4: Grammar: Identifying the Past Tense

Regular Past Tense

Regular verbs form past tense by adding -ed to the base form.

Example: walk----walked

If the base form of the verb ends with an e, the regular past is formed by adding -d.

Example: rake---raked

Identify the regular verbs in the past tense in the text below. Regular past tense verbs end in -ed.

Text

Between the end of the Civil War (1865) and the beginning of the Great Depression (1929), almost two million African Americans moved from the rural South to look for new opportunities. While some moved west, most of this Great Migration, as the large number of African Americans leaving the South was called, moved to the Northeast and Upper Midwest. More than two-thirds of them moved to the following cities: New York, Chicago, Philadelphia, St. Louis, Detroit, Pittsburgh, Cleveland, and Indianapolis. Many African Americans did not have money to move themselves, but factory owners and other businesses helped pay for their moves. Because of racism, African American workers still had the lower-paying jobs in steel mills, mines, construction, and meat packing. In the railroad industry, they often worked as porters or servants. In other businesses, they worked as janitors, waiters, or cooks. African American women, who faced racism and sexism, often worked as maids and domestic servants. Nevertheless, African Americans earned higher wages in the North than they did for the same jobs in the South, and found housing more easily. However, life in the city was still difficult. African Americans still experienced the higher cost of living in the North, especially in terms of rent and food. As a result, housing was often overcrowded and dirty. They still experienced racism from landlords, bankers and neighbors. So why move to the North, since the economic problems were similar to those in the South? African Americans moved for non-economic gains. In the North, they found greater educational opportunities and personal freedom. Similarly, unlike the South where African Americans often experienced violence, life in larger, crowded cities permitted African Americans to move, work, and speak freely.

Irregular Past Tense

Irregular past tense is formed by changing the spelling. Because the spelling is irregular, there is not one rule for the formation of irregular past tense verbs, and these verbs need to be learned by memory.

Examine the text again. Can you identify three irregular past tense verbs?

Check Your Answers

Regular verbs in the simple past tense are underlined below. Irregular verbs in the simple past tense are bolded.

Between the end of the Civil War (1865) and the beginning of the Great Depression (1929), almost two million African Americans moved from the rural South to look for new opportunities. While some moved west, most of this Great Migration, as the large number of African Americans leaving the South was called, moved to the Northeast and Upper Midwest. More than two-thirds of them moved to the following cities: New York, Chicago, Philadelphia, St. Louis, Detroit, Pittsburgh, Cleveland, and Indianapolis. Many African Americans **did not have** money to move themselves, but factory owners and other businesses helped pay for their moves. Because of racism, African American workers still **had** the lower-paying jobs in steel mills, mines, construction, and meat packing. In the railroad industry, they often worked as porters or servants. In other businesses, they worked as janitors, waiters, or cooks. African American women, who faced racism and sexism, often worked as maids and domestic servants. Nevertheless, African Americans earned higher wages in the North than they **did** for the same jobs in the South, and **found** housing more easily. However, life in the city **was** still difficult. African Americans still experienced the higher cost of living in the North, especially in terms of rent and food. As a result, housing **was** often overcrowded and dirty. They still experienced racism from landlords, bankers and neighbors. So why move to the North, since the economic problems **were** similar to those in the South? African Americans moved for non-economic gains. In the North, they **found** greater educational opportunities and personal freedom. Similarly, unlike

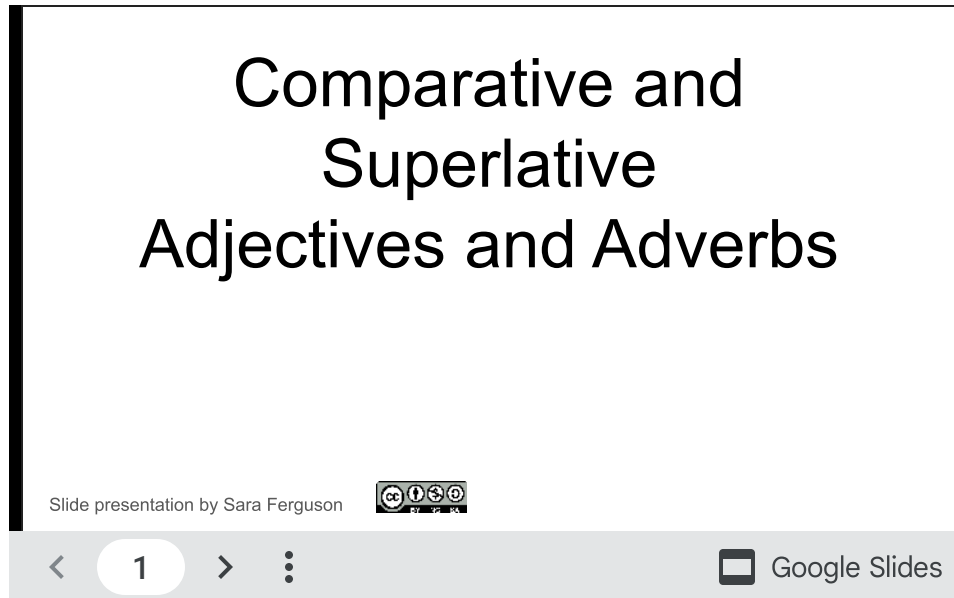
the South where African Americans often experienced violence, life in larger, crowded cities permitted African Americans to move, work, and speak freely.

Find more information about the simple past tense in the second module in this series, [Getting to Know You](#).

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3.5: Grammar: Comparative and Superlative Adjectives and Adverbs

This lesson includes [slides for classroom presentation](#).



Comparative Adjectives

Compare two nouns using a comparative adjective. Which two nouns are compared in these sentences? What is the comparative adjective?

- San Diego, CA is larger than El Cajon, CA
- Black Mountain is higher than Mount Helix

Answers

- The two nouns are "San Diego, CA" and "El Cajon, CA" and the comparative adjective is "larger"
- The two nouns are "Black Mountain" and "Mount Helix" and the comparative adjective is "higher"

Did you notice what word follows the comparative adjective?

Answer

Than

How Do We Make Comparative Adjectives?

What do you notice about this list?

- Larger
- Higher
- More diverse
- Smaller
- More populated
- More difficult
- Richer
- Easier
- More majestic
- More historical
- Deeper

Rules for Writing Comparative Adjectives

- If the word is one syllable, add -er to the end of the word
- If the word ends with -e, add -r
- If the word is one syllable and ends with CVC (consonant-vowel-consonant), double the final consonant
- If the word is two syllables, use "more" + adjective
- If the word is two syllables and ends with -y, drop the -y and add -ier
- Comparative adjectives are followed by "than"

One-syllable adjectives	Two-syllable adjectives ending with -y	Two-or-more-syllable adjectives	Irregular adjectives
Larger	Easier	More diverse	Good = better
Richer	Happier	More difficult	Far = further/farther
Deeper	Hungrier	More majestic	Little = less
Higher	Curlier	More populated	Many = more
Smaller			Bad = worse
Bigger			

Comparative Adverbs

Read the sentences below and identify the comparative adverbs...

- I like to go hiking, but I hike more slowly than my kids
- African Americans moved to the north during the Great Migration because they could vote more freely there
- If you want to sightsee in San Diego, take a car; cars travel faster than buses in San Diego
- It takes longer to visit the zoo than to visit Balboa Park

Answers

- The comparative adverb is "more slowly than"
- The comparative adverb is "more freely"
- The comparative adverb is "faster than"
- The comparative adverb is "longer...than"

How Do We Make Comparative Adverbs?

One-syllable adverbs	Two-or-more-syllable adverbs (including -ly adverbs)
Adverb + -er + "than"	"More" + adverb + "than"

Practice Quizzes

Check your understanding of comparative adjectives and adverbs. Take practice quizzes at the websites below...

- [Comparative Adjectives](#)
- [Comparative Adverbs](#)

Superlative Adjectives and Adverbs

How are superlatives different from comparatives?

Read the sentences below and identify the superlative adjectives and adverbs...

- Cowles Mountain is the highest point in the city of San Diego
- It is also the most popular mountain for hiking
- On the other hand, Woodson Mountain is the best place to take a photo, because it has Potato Chip Rock

- You can hike most easily at Torrey Pines State Beach

Answers

- The superlative is "the highest"
- The superlative is "the most popular"
- The superlative is "the best"
- The superlative is "most easily"

How Do We Make Superlative Adjectives and Adverbs?

Examine the superlative forms below. How is the superlative formed?

- The highest point
- The most popular mountain
- The best place
- Take most easily

Adjectives with one syllable	Adjectives with two or more syllables	Adjectives ending with -y	Irregular adjectives and adverbs	Adverbs with one syllable	Adverbs with two or more syllables (including -ly)
The highest The lowest The tallest The strangest	The most popular The most beautiful The least challenging	The easiest The earliest The hungriest	The best The worst The least The fewest The farthest/furthest	The fastest The longest The latest	The most happily The most quickly The most seriously

Spelling when adding -er or -est to the end of an adjective or adverb...

- For most adjectives/adverbs, just add -er or -est, e.g. darker, quicker, fastest
- If the adjective/adverb ends with e, just add -r or -st, e.g. stranger, strangest
- If the adjective ends with -y or -ly, drop the y and add -ier or -iest, e.g. uglier, ugliest
- If the adverb ends with -ly, do not add -er or -est, use "more" or "most" instead
- Use the CVC rule, one-syllable words with consonant-vowel-consonant pattern double the final consonant, e.g. hotter, hottest

Takeaways: Comparatives and Superlatives

- Comparatives are used to compare two items; superlatives compare three or more items
 - EX: Torrey Pines State Park is closer than Yosemite National Park (two parks, comparative form)
 - EX: Of all the parks in Southern California, Torrey Pines is the best (many parks, superlative form)
- Negative comparisons can be made by using "less" and "least" (instead of "more" and "most")
 - EX: Torrey Pines State Park is less crowded than Yosemite National Park
 - EX: Of all the parks in Southern California, Torrey Pines is the least crowded
- Comparatives are formed with adjective/adverb + -er + "than" or with "more"/"less" + adjective/adverb + "than"
 - Depends on the number of syllables and spelling of the word
- Superlatives are formed with "the" + adjective/adverb + -est or with "the most"/"the least" + adjective/adverb
 - Depends on the number of syllables and spelling of the word
- Irregular adjectives and adverbs
 - Good/well--better--the best
 - Bad/badly--worse--the worst
 - Little--less--least
 - Much--more--most
 - Far--farther/further--farthest/furthest

- Early--earlier--earliest
 - "Early" is an adjective and adverb, the form is irregular for adverbs

Video

Watch [this video](#) for more explanation of comparatives and superlatives...

Practice

Practice using comparatives and superlatives. Make recommendations to your classmates about the following places in your city or area. Your instructor might have you post your recommendations on a discussion board or pass them to your classmates for comment...

- Compare two restaurants. Which one is better? Why?
- Recommend the most exciting activity for a family with kids. Explain why...
- What's the best place to see a movie in your city/area? Why?
- What sights do you recommend a tourist see when they visit? Compare two or three...
- Which city/area is the easiest for a new immigrant to move into? Why?

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

4: Guided Video Tour Project

[4.1: Randall's ESL Listening Lab: Sightseeing](#)

[4.2: Assignment: Guided Video Tour](#)

[4.3: Vocabulary Review](#)

[4.4: Grammar Review](#)

[4.5: Grammar Review 2](#)

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4.1: Randall's ESL Listening Lab: Sightseeing

Vocabulary

Identify the words and expressions below that you know.

- Guide (n)
- Art museum
- Restaurant
- Downtown
- Zoo
- Souvenir
- Subway
- Seashore
- Beach
- Recommend (v)

Which of these sights does your city have? What other sights do you recommend people see when they visit your city?

Listening Activity

Listen to [this recording](#) and then answer the questions found below the recording...

Map

View the map of San Diego...

Which of these sights do you recommend?

Write a conversation with a classmate. You are visiting San Diego and you would like to see some sights. Where should you go and why?

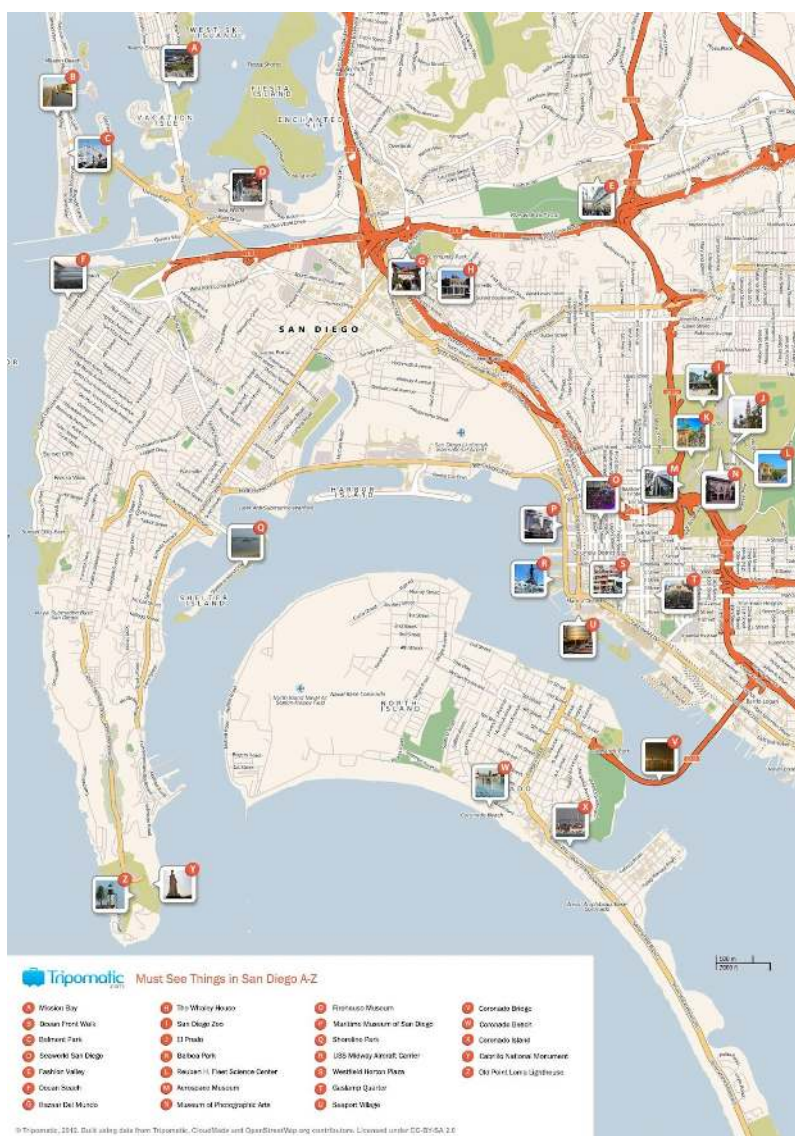


Figure 4.1.1: Map of San Diego

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4.2: Assignment: Guided Video Tour

Guided Video Tours

For this project you will create a guided video tour. This project will allow you to show your ability to analyze and create a video in a new genre. You will practice speaking English on the theme we have studied for several weeks. You will be able to use the grammar and vocabulary you learned in this module, and show your new skills with the technology. Finally, this project will allow you to see your classmates on video, enjoy each other's work, and practice listening to each other in English.

Assignment: Choose a place you would like to show your instructor and classmates. It could be your home, your garden, your street, the college campus, your child's school, or a nearby park or shopping center. You can even use a map and photos to present this video from your home. Write a guided video tour of that place. Your tone should be friendly, informal and positive. Use descriptive adjectives to tell us about your place. You should present at least ten sentences describing and explaining your place.

Time: 3-5 minutes

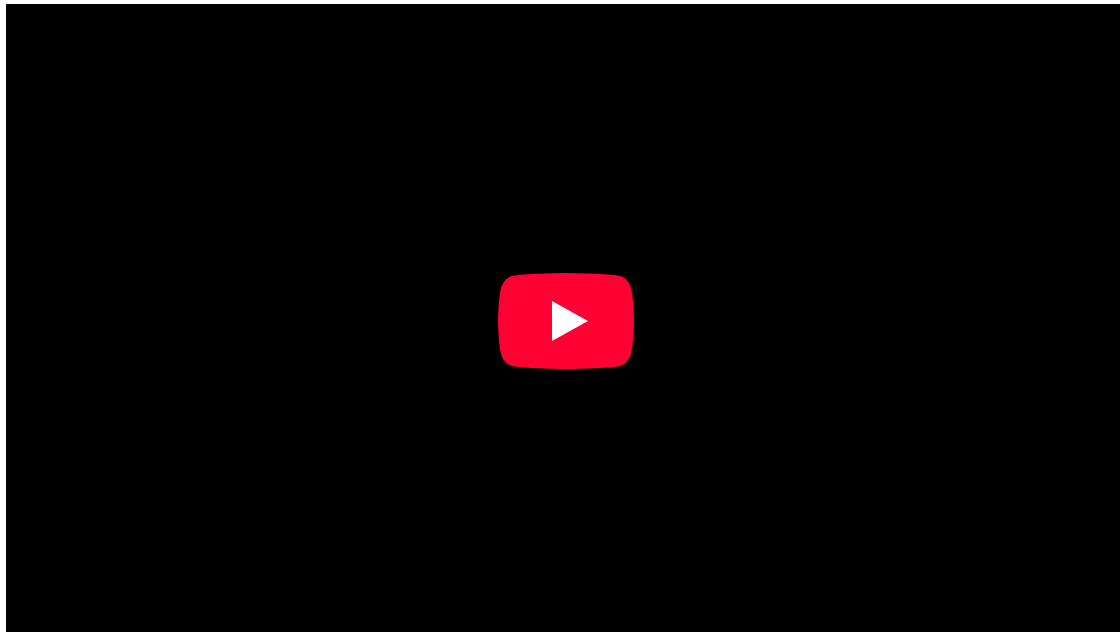
Audience: Your instructor and classmates

Purpose: You may decide. You can inform, entertain, or persuade your audience to visit.

[A rubric is attached to help you understand how your project will be graded.](#)

[Watch the two guided tour videos below for examples of the genre.](#)

San Diego State American Language Institute





Ken Kramer's California Tower

We're sorry, but there was an error playing this video. Please try again later.

[Check your understanding.](#)

[Answer the questions about Ken Kramer's California Tower.](#)

A. What is the purpose of the video "The California Tower, Balboa Park?"

1. To inform and entertain the viewer by showing the inside of the California Tower.
2. To persuade the viewer to visit the California Tower.
3. To persuade the viewer to donate money to the California Tower.
4. To educate the viewer about the history of the California Tower.

B. Who is the audience for the video, "The California Tower, Balboa Park?"

1. School children preparing for a visit to the tower.
2. Tourists considering a visit to the tower.
3. Students writing a research paper about Balboa Park.
4. San Diego residents who want to learn fun facts about their city.

C. What is the main idea of the video "The California Tower, Balboa Park?"

1. There are too many birds in the California Tower.
2. The California tower is a good place for tourists to visit.
3. San Diego has some memorable sights, including the California Tower.
4. We should spend more tax money to improve the California Tower.

From the video, list at least three positive facts about the California Tower. They can be pieces of information that Ken Kramer talks about, or information that you learned from the images only.

The video also shows some negative information about the tower. List at least one piece of information that is negative.

Answers to question above: A-1, B-4, C-3

[Check your understanding.](#)

[Answer the questions about San Diego State University American Language Institute.](#)

A. What is the purpose of the video "The American Language Institute at SDSU"?

1. To entertain San Diego residents.
2. To persuade international students to attend the American Language Institute.
3. To inform students about the services at the American Language Institute.
4. To persuade parents to visit their children at the American Language Institute.

B. Who is the audience for the video "The American Language Institute at SDSU"?

1. International students
2. San Diego residents
3. Elementary school students in San Diego
4. San Diego State University professors

C. Who is the narrator for this video?

1. a San Diego resident
2. a news reporter
3. a San Diego State University student
4. a San Diego State University professor

D. What is the main idea of this video?

1. San Diego State University ALI is a wonderful place to attend school.
2. SDSU ALI has good professors.
3. SDSU ALI has good technology.
4. ALI Students can use the gym at SDSU.

After watching this video, would you want to attend SDSU American Language Institute? Why or why not?

Answers to question above: A-2, B-1, C-3, D-1

[How Well Do You Understand the Assignment?](#)

Sometimes the best way to understand an assignment is to look at examples of the kind of work you will be expected to create. You have watched two examples of video guided tours similar to the videos you should make for your end-of-unit project. Can you guess the answers to these questions based on the video examples?

True or false?

1. You should narrate your video. (This means you should speak while showing images)
2. You must memorize your narration.
3. The narration should be a list of words, not sentences.
4. The video should be about ten minutes long.
5. The video should persuade the viewer to visit.
6. The video must be about your garden.

7. The video must be about an important place in your city.
8. You should show yourself in the video.
9. The video camera should stay in one place.
10. You need to buy a high quality, expensive video camera for this assignment.
11. The video should show mostly positive information.
12. You should not make any mistakes when you are speaking.
13. The video can talk about history.
14. You should leave some time to get help if you have trouble with the video technology.
15. You should plan what you are going to say and practice beforehand.
16. Your tone in this video should be very formal.

Answers

1. T This is a writing and speaking assignment, so you must speak on the video.
2. F Do not memorize word for word, but you should practice and make some notes to help you remember what you want to say.
3. F The narration should be sentences.
4. F The video should be 3 to 5 minutes long.
5. F It may persuade your viewer to visit, or it may have another purpose.
6. F It may be about your garden, but you may give a tour of another place, too.
7. F It may be about a place such as your home, your street, or your favorite shopping mall.
8. T At least a short time must be spent in front of the camera.
9. F The camera should move, so you can show different things in your tour.
10. F You can use your phone or tablet, or borrow one from a friend.
11. T Yes. This is a tour of a place you like.
12. F It's OK to make mistakes. You should practice and prepare first, though.
13. T The video may have historical facts.
14. T YES! Start your project early, so you will have time to get help if the technology fails.
15. T YES! Plan and prepare first. You might need to record yourself several times before you are happy with the project.
16. F The tone should be friendly and informal.

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4.3: Vocabulary Review

Vocabulary from Listening Activities

This page includes a list of target vocabulary for each activity in the module "People and Places." Complete each task to practice using the vocabulary.

Sightseeing

- Guide (n)
- Art museum (n)
- Restaurant (n)
- Downtown (n)
- Zoo (n)
- Souvenir (n)
- Subway (n)
- Seashore (n)
- Beach (n)
- Recommend (v)

Practice

Answer these questions with your classmates.

- What restaurant do you recommend to your classmates?
- Read the following vocabulary words out loud. Does your city have one? Where is it?
 - Art museum
 - Zoo
 - Subway
 - Beach
 - Seashore
- Have you ever brought a souvenir home from your travels? What was it?
- Where can you find a city guide to your city? Do you need a city guide when you go downtown in your city?

Seasons

- Cold
- Hot
- Humid
- Dry
- Windy
- Pleasant
- Cool
- Snowy
- Breezy
- Hike
- Stroll
- Fly kites
- Picnic
- Sledding
- Visit
- Sunbathe
- Surf
- Fall

- Spring
- Summer
- Winter

Practice

Answer these questions with your classmates.

- Use the vocabulary above to talk about the weather in your city. How is the weather today? How is the weather during each season?
- Use the vocabulary above. What are some activities you like to do in the summer? In the winter? In the fall or spring?

Vocabulary from Tourist Blurb "Welcome to East County"

- Hills
- Mountains
- Lakes
- Wildflowers
- Canyon
- Beach
- Desert
- Golf course
- Casino
- Rodeo
- Resort
- Art gallery
- Restaurant
- Mountain biking
- Rock climbing
- Fishing
- Camping
- Hiking

Practice

Answer these questions with your classmates.

- Use the vocabulary above. Do you enjoy any of the activities on the list? Why or why not?
- Where is a lake near your city?
- If you could only live near a beach or a mountain, which would you choose? Why?
- Read the vocabulary below. Have you ever been to one of these? Did you enjoy it?
 - Golf course
 - Casino
 - Rodeo
 - Resort
 - Art gallery
- What is the difference between an art gallery and an art museum?

Vocabulary from Videos "Contributions of Immigrants"

Match the vocabulary word to the definition.

Vocabulary Words

- Culture (n)
- Immigrant (n)

- Grief (n)
- Joy (n)
- Integration (n)
- Hispanic (adj)
- Public (adj)

Definitions

- A feeling of sadness or something that causes sadness
- A person who comes to live permanently in a foreign country
- The way of life of a group of people, including art, music, religion, language, food, tradition, and many other aspects
- Coming from a Spanish-speaking country
- Relating to or open to all people in an area
- A feeling of happiness or something that causes happiness
- When two groups mix (blend, combine) in a society and both have equal value

Vocabulary from Textbook Reading "The Great Migration"

- Migration (n)
- Rural (adj)
- Historical (adj)
- Factor (n)
- Civil War (proper noun)
- Slavery (n)
- Racism (n)
- Lynching (n)
- Flee (v)
- Vote (v)
- Violence (n)
- Push (v)
- Pull (v)

Write the word that matches the meaning below. Then add related word forms next to the definition.

- People, situations, or things that existed in the past: _____ (adj)
 - _____ (n), _____ (adv)
- To formally choose in a meeting or an election: _____ (v)
 - _____ (n), _____ (n-person)
- Behavior that is intended to hurt, injure, or kill people: _____ (n)
 - _____ (adj), _____ (adv)
- The belief that people of some races are inferior to others, and the behavior which is the result of this belief: _____ (n)
 - _____ (n-root word), _____ (adj)
- Murder by hanging without a trial by an angry crowd: _____ (n)
 - _____ (v)
- Force something to move away from you: _____ (v)
- Force something to come toward you: _____ (v)
- Run away or escape from something or someone: _____ (v)
- When a group of people or animals moves from one place to another: _____ (n)
 - _____ (v), _____ (adj)
- Something that affects an event or situation: _____ (n)

Vocabulary from Textbook Reading "Overcoming Culture Shock"

Use complete sentences to write the answer to these questions.

- What are several examples of taboos in your culture?
- Do people make a toast in your culture? If so, what do they say before they drink?
- What facial expressions do people make when they are happy? Angry?
- Give an example of a time you felt overwhelmed
- What are three customs you follow from your culture?
- Have you experienced culture shock? What did it feel like?
- What are some things people can do to adjust quickly to a new culture?
- What is one example of a nonverbal gesture?

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4.4: Grammar Review

Simple Present Tense Practice

Practice with the simple present tense. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the simple present tense.

The Mission District in San Francisco, California _____ (have) many immigrants from Mexico, Latin America, and Central America. People from these countries _____ (speak) Spanish, so they are sometimes called Hispanic. The people who live in the Mission District _____ (keep) their cultural identity by sharing their food, religion, art, and music. The music _____ (allow) them to experience their griefs and joys--that is, the things that make them sad and happy. The artists _____ (create) public art that is outside where everyone _____ (see) it and _____ (enjoy) it. The video _____ (show) that the Mission District is a good example of integration, where the old culture and new culture _____ (mix) peacefully.

More Practice

For more practice with the simple present tense, visit [this website](#). Watch the videos and complete the activities, then visit [this website](#). Read the instructions and complete the activities.

Imperative Mood and Simple Present Tense Practice

Practice with the imperative mood and simple present tense. Write five instructions for a friend visiting your city. After a sentence with imperative mood, explain your instructions with another sentence in simple present tense. Verbs are suggested below, or use your own.

- Don't miss
- Spend
- Bring
- Visit
- Don't forget
- Remember
- Take
- See

Verbs and Subjects Practice

Practice identifying verbs and subjects. Identify the verbs and subjects in each sentence.

- Every year, about 20,000 grey whales swim past the west coast of Vancouver Island
- The whales travel from Mexico to the Arctic and back again
- The whole trip is about 16,000 kilometres
- The whales travel very close to the shore
- On the east coast of Vancouver Island, you can spot mammals of a different sort
- The Bathtub Race started out as a silly event in 1967
- Dragon boat racing started in China over 2,000 years ago
- It returned as a yearly event in 1989
- The festival begins with a ceremony
- Each boat has a dragon's head on the front and a tail on the back

Compound Sentences

Revisit the last paragraph of "Overcoming Culture Shock," below. Can you find two compound sentences? Identify the FANBOYS in each sentence.

After two weeks in Spain, Caitlin understood that adjusting to a new culture takes time. It can take weeks or months to recover from culture shock, and it can take years to fully adjust to living in a new culture. During her trip, she made new lifelong friends.

She learned a lot about Spain, but she also discovered a lot about herself and her own culture

Are the sentences below compound? If not, why not? Identify the verbs, subjects, and FANBOYS.

- It was exciting, but she felt alone and uncomfortable
- Maria's mother kissed Caitlin on both cheeks, and Caitlin was surprised
- People feel incompetent and nervous because of culture shock
- She felt overwhelmed by the new customs, language, and surroundings
- There was new food, new daily schedules, and new rules of etiquette
- They spoke loudly and they argued about politics
- That night, Caitlin crawled into a strange bed, but she wanted to go home
- We relate to others through shared cultural norms, and ordinarily, we don't even notice them

Compound sentences use "and," "or," "but," and "so" to connect two clauses. Write one sentence on each line. Then write two compound sentences of your own. Remember to use a comma before the FANBOYS...

- Cultural norms are difficult to understand. Many people feel culture shock when they visit a new country.

- _____

- I feel culture shock every time I visit France. I still enjoy visiting there.

- _____

- You can avoid visiting a new country. You can visit and try to adjust quickly.

- _____

- Learning the language is important. It is not the only cause of culture shock.

- _____

- _____

- _____

Editing Practice

Practice One

Read the email below and correct the errors. You will find 3 adjective use errors, 4 comparative/superlative errors, and 11 capitalization errors.



Dear britanny Allen,

Thank you for considering a visit to the Del Mar Resort in sunny san diego, california. We think you will enjoy a wonderful time here.

The area offers most beautiful beaches in the world. spend an afternoon swimming or surfing at Del Mar Beach, or go hiking at Torrey Pines State Park. Remember to take a picnic and enjoy the sound of the waves after your hike. The weather here is more warm than other cities, and it's always fun to eat outside.

After an excited day in the beautiful outdoors, try one of our restaurants delicious. Southern California is famous for our fantastic mexican food, but we have many other restaurants excellent , as well. On just one street, you can try thai, vietnamese, chinese, brazilian and french cuisine. It is the diversest area in the world.

Finally, don't forget to spend some time in San Diego, just a short drive away. San Diego is famous for the zoo and Balboa Park. The zoo is most expensive than Balboa Park, but the animals are fascinated. I recommend you spend at least three hours at the zoo, especially if you brought your kids!

Again, I want to extend my thanks for your interest. Please contact me if you have any questions. We are looking forward to seeing you.

The Concierge at Del Mar Resorts

Practice Two

Read the email below and correct the errors. You will find 1 compound sentence error, 3 superlative adjective errors, 5 adjective errors, 2 imperative mood errors, and 4 errors with activity vocabulary words.



Hey Seth!

I'm so glad you are going to visit Crawford, Colorado! I lived there for 2 years, or let me give you some advice about places to visit.

First, spend some time at the Black Canyon of the Gunnison. This national park is famous because it is not the most big canyon in the US, but it is the most deep. It is a place beautiful and wild, and you can take some wonderful photos. You can go camp or hike there, too.

Are careful! There are bears in the park, and the cliffs are steep. If you take your kids, do let them fall!

Second, you should stay at the Stonehouse Inn. This little bed and breakfast offers rooms cozy and a breakfast complete. The inn has views of mountains rugged and blue skies.

Finally, don't miss the Crawford reservoir. The reservoir is a small lake. You can go fish or swim there. You can even rent a paddle board or boat to spend the day on the water.

I wish I could meet you there! It is one of my favoritest places in the world. Have fun!

Joanne

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[Black Canyon of the Gunnison photo](#)

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4.5: Grammar Review 2

Subjects and Verbs

- Know how to find the subject and the verb of a sentence.
 - The **subject** is the person, place, or thing doing an action.
 - The **verb** shows the action or "being."

Practice: Identify the subject and verb. There may be more than one subject or more than one verb.

- My friends and I are going to the movies after class.
- We want to see the new Spider-man movie.
- Spider-man is our favorite superhero.
- The movie theater at the mall is cheaper.
- I like to eat popcorn, and sometimes I also buy a soda.

Active and Stative Verbs

- Know the difference between simple present and present continuous/progressive

Practice: Choose simple present or present continuous in the sentences below.

- We _____ (have) dinner at my grandmother's house every Sunday.
- Tonight, she _____ (cook) vegetarian pasta because my sister _____ (not/eat) meat.
- Pasta _____ (be) my favorite food.
- Right now, I _____ (make) some salad to bring to her house.
- My sister usually _____ (bring) dessert.
- I _____ (be) so excited for dinner.

Common and Proper Nouns

- Know the difference between common nouns and proper nouns.
 - Common nouns are people, places, or things in general.
 - Proper nouns are people, places, or things specifically; you should capitalize the first letter of a proper noun.

Practice: Change the capitalization of the proper nouns. Some sentences have no proper nouns.

- We love going to the mountains in the winter months.
- This january we will go to big bear mountain.
- My grandchildren go to lexington elementary school.
- That elementary school is close to my house.

Compound Sentences

- Know how to write compound sentences
 - Compound sentences have two independent clauses connected by a comma and a coordinating conjunction (FANBOYS).
 - The most common coordinating conjunctions are "and," "but," "or," and "so."

Practice: Write your own compound sentences about a family member or a close friend. Use "and," "but," "or," and "so" at least one time each.

Adjective Word Order

- Know how to use adjectives in order.

Practice

Write a paragraph using adjectives to describe the favorite thing in your house. Use at least one compound sentence. Practice using simple present and present progressive verbs. When you finish, identify all the verbs in your paragraph. Next, give your paper to a partner. Check your verb tenses together.

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Worksheet created by Jaquelin Yang, Grossmont College

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Index

G

Getting to Know You

[To the Instructor](#)

Index

G

Getting to Know You

[To the Instructor](#)

Glossary

Sample Word 1 | Sample Definition 1

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 - [InfoPage](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
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 - [To the Instructor](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1: Introductions and the Contributions of Immigrants](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
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 - [1.2: Traditional Paragraph Structure and Email Etiquette](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.3: Assignment: Writing a Formal Email](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.4: Videos: The Contributions of Immigrants](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.5: Grammar: What is a Verb?](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.6: Grammar: Simple Sentences](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
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 - [2.6: Grammar: Present Tense Verbs](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.7: Grammar: Compound Sentences](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.8: Grammar: Descriptive Adjectives](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.9: Assignment: Write a Persuasive Email](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3: Push and Pull Factors](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.1: Reading a Textbook: The Great Migration](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.4: Grammar: Identifying the Past Tense](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [3.5: Grammar: Comparative and Superlative Adjectives and Adverbs](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.2: Reading: Culture Shock](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.3: Grammar: Adverbs](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [4: Guided Video Tour Project](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
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 - [4.2: Assignment: Guided Video Tour](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
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 - [4.4: Grammar Review](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [4.5: Grammar Review 2](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Back Matter](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Index](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Index](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Glossary](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Detailed Licensing](#) - [Undeclared](#)